She-ra Fictober 2022

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/42062202.

Rating:
General Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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F/F

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Catra (She-Ra)

Character:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra)

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Fictober 2022, Fictober, Fluff and Angst, One Shot, Short One Shot, One Shot Collection, tbh ill just be spewing thoughts, no beta we die like my braincells, i dont have a betareader, correction: im my own beta reader and im Tired, October Prompt Challenge, i know that it's supposed to be a spoopy month but i accidentally made it fluffy, i should've called this flufftober

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She-ra Fictober 2022

by notahumanweirdo

Summary

sometimes I regret my life choices. This month, I'll share them.

31 days, prompts and fics. Wish me luck!

It's a collection of one shots and the prompt list is from Fictober 2022

Notes

remember when i said i was busy and probably posting less? yeah, well, im still busy but i saw a prompt list yesterday of fictober and i didn't want to wait a whole year to enter

i don't know if i'll finish this, but we'll see

fics will be in various lengths, mainly catradora

usually i re-read a fic at least 3 times, but that wont be happening here

i aim to write at least 100 words, and warnings, if any, will be put in the author's notes at the beginning

that's probably all, thank you for reading!

Pro gamer Catra

Prompt: "I chose you."

***

'Noooooo!' Adora exclaims, her heart breaking ever so slightly.

'Do you have any plans left, princess?'

She has looked at all the possibilities and truly, there's only one option left.

Catra starts snickering.

'Shut up.'

'Are you sure you about this?'

That earned her a glare.

'Hey! I was just checking.' Catra says. However, ever the piece of shit, she starts snickering again.

Adora focusses on her ds screen again, looking intently at the Magikarp standing in the battle scene. 'Don't listen to her. I chose you for a reason.'

Catra hums. 'And that's to lose even faster.' On her own ds, she chooses an Kartana.

Their two Pokémon's stand in front of each other in the virtual battlefield. The Magikarp looking extra sad with the imposing Kartana standing opposite of it.

Adora frowns her eyebrows and bites her lip. In the time that it takes her to come up with a battle plan, Catra has enough chances to admire the blonde. They're sitting next to each other on Catra's bed, snuggled underneath a blanket to fend of the early

October chill. Their shoulders so close that they often touch when one of them moves a little.

She can feel Adora sigh next to her. Her screen reads some dialogue and she sees that Adora chose the move splash.

Catra snickers again, silently, but loses it once Adora's Magikarp faints in one hit.

'It isn't funny!'

'It kind of is.'

Adora pouts, her bottom lip jutted out, as she reads that she lost the battle. She really thought that she could beat Catra this time! Catra only had two Pokémon's and she had six!

Too bad it didn't work that way.

'Hey.' Catra bumps her shoulder. 'Cheer up. You got one of them!' She gets a small smile back, only the corner of Adora's mouth going up. 'I think you're actually capable of beating me next time, if you stop choosing Pokémon's that look like horses.'

'Don't talk bad about Swift Wind, Sugar and Racecar ever again!'

'You don't even know their real names!'

'I don't have to. I don't want to play this anymore.' They have been at this for a while now, after all. Adora puts her ds away and Catra does the same. She puts her head on Catra's shoulder, and instinctively Catra wraps an arm around her.

'Me neither. Beating you gets kind of boring after a while.'

'And I thought you'd be nice for a second.'

Catra wraps her other arm also around Adora, into a better hug. 'I am.'

They both shimmy down, to fully lay on the bed. Adora moves and twists, so she lays half on top of Catra, her head on her chest. Catra’s heart is thumping softly. It’s an even nicer sound than the rain outside on the window.

Adora may not have won, but in Catra’s arms she still feels like a winner.

Adventurer/archaeologist Adora x Genie Catra

Chapter Notes

CW: near-death experiences, almost-drowning, implied character dead

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Prompt: "Nobody warned you about me?"

***

Adora is walking in the Crimson waste. An abandoned temple is standing before her in all its might, several feet away.

Good. She didn't waste her time going on this month long trip.

A drip of sweat is falling of her forehead, and her head feels warm due to the hat she's wearing and the power of the sun.

This has to be it.

She looks once more on her map.

Now there's only one thing she can do to be sure. She has to go inside.

***

After walking through the entrance, a long hallway awaits. It's very dim, but she lit a torch, the flames flickering on the walls.

At first, the walls where empty. Not even some foliage dared to grow there, so heated by the day sun. But the more she walks, the more she suspects that she is right.

Writing of an ancient village decorates the temple.

She knows it for sure.

This is a temple of the first ones.

***

A couple of booby traps are nothing for Adora!

Too bad she couldn’t prove it.

On the other hand, she also didn’t mind the calm walk towards the middle of the temple. There wasn’t even a maze, or a gigantic spider. Even though there was less of an epic tale this way, Adora was unperturbed by the lack of adventure.

She preferred boobies anyway.

The middle of the temple had an opening on the top. Looking up above her, she can ssee that the twilight came upon her. The last rays seem to brighten up an altar, something sitting on top of it.

Adora sips from her water, a droplet falling from her mouth that she wipes away.

She inspects the ground, looking one more time for any potential triggers for traps. But no, she only saw the ground beneath her, covered with the most intrinsic designs. Even Persian carpets would look unspectacular if laid next to it.

It all points towards the altar.

Guess there’s only one thing to do.

She walks closer and closer and sees that there’s… an old lamp?

That can’t be right.

Adora picks it up and looks around.

Nothing happens.

Maybe she was indeed in the wrong temple.

Her coordinates were right though?

All she got is a dusty old lamp.

She might as well take it home as a souvenir for Lance and George from the institute. It was ridiculously dirty though. Sure, they preferred artifacts covered with 'dirt of a century', but this was ridiculous.

With the underside of her shirt, she cleaned it. It seems to shine in the soft moonlight again.

Only it never dimmed.

Why didn't it dim?

Adora feels like her head begins to pound, looking too much at the bright light. Is the temple beginning to rumble? What is happening?

She frantically looks around to her left and right, but she can't see anything except rocks starting to fall.

And a mist?

She's getting woozy and—

***

Adora wakes up. She opens her eyes and is laying in the sand.

Don't tell her it was a dream. She could swear she was almost there and-

Her gaze looks around and she sees a fallen temple in the distance.

Oh.

Could it be real?

But how did she survive?

A voice cleared next to her.

Adora moves her head to look at the person standing in front of her. It was a woman, in some outdated clothes, looking awfully familiar to the first ones time period.

'What do *you* want?'

'Uhhh…' Adora tried to remember everything she had ever learned about speaking, because as the gorgeous woman stood before her, she suddenly forgot. 'Did you save me?'

'*Uhhh*,' she mocked Adora's tone, 'yeah? You woke me up, and I can't exactly let you die before you make your wishes.'

What was this woman talking about? Maybe Adora had inhaled too much sand on the way out, or maybe the woman had. 'Wishes?'

'Seriously? Nobody warned you about me?'

'No?'

She rolled her eyes. 'So you casually stumbled upon a magic lamp and woke up the genie living in it? I was having some of the best rests of my lifetime.'

'Magic lamp? Genie?' She knows that the last sentences that Adora muttered were all questions, but *what*?

'Don't play dumb with me.'

Adora bites her lip. 'I was looking for a sword.'

The woman drags both of her hands down on her face. 'You could wish for one.'

The only thing that Adora did was move her head to the side. Apparently that was enough for her to explain something about magic, genies and wishes.

***

Catra.

That's what the genie was called.

She had a quirk to keep out of her lamp as much as possible. The lamp that earned a permanent place on Adora's belt. Something about it feeling claustrophobic and wanting to see how the world turned out in the time that she was gone.

Catra also had another quirk, and that was that she was a pain in the ass at the best of times. She always made comments about how Adora is dumb and wasting and *risking* her life looking for artifacts.

She didn't understand, just like many others. She just needed to do this.

***

Somewhere more on the edge of the Crimson waste, there were civilians. Lucky for her, they knew how to party.

That's why Adora and Catra were sitting in a random booth, both a cradling a drink. There was sand everywhere on the ground. Whenever people walked with too much vigour, it blew up and they had to shield their drinks.

Sand was nice, but not to drink. Adora already had too much experience with that.

It was mostly silent, but they tolerated each other. That was until Catra had to ask. 'Why don't you wish for anything?'

Adora could read through the lines. Not always, but she could this time. ‘Because nothing I want can be wished for.’

It was silent after that again.

***

Adora climbed a mountain. This time far from the dessert, opting to go look for somewhere in a jungle. Catra was in her lamp again, not wanting to distract Adora.

Oh, and also, it rained.

A lot.

And that’s how Adora’s hand slipped as she fell.

And that’s how Catra left her lamp and saved her for the second time.

***

The next time, Adora was in a cave.

It was a cool cave, very scenic. There were paintings on them from several *thousands* of years ago.

Too bad she couldn’t really enjoy it, since she was bitten by a poisonous snake. At least the cave wall that she was sitting against was quite comfortable.

Catra looked at her for a while, when Adora suffered in silence. ‘You’re seriously not going to wish for anything?’

Adora looked her in the eye. ‘Nah.’

The staring contest was getting more serious. She looked so much that even in the darkened cave she could make out Catra’s figure.

(Let’s not mention the fact that Catra was kind of glowing. Somewhere along the trip Adora had asked about that. Apparently

it’s some magic stuff.)

One sigh from Catra was all it cost for Adora to get saved again.

***

‘Why are you still looking for that stupid sword?’

Adora looked at her from across the campfire. They were now somewhere out in the woods. The dessert and jungle long forgotten.

This night, she couldn’t sleep and had twisted the lamp in her hands, looking at her own reflection. Thinking about stuff she shouldn’t.

She only noticed that she woke Catra up, by the genie fuming a little bit at her. She had looked up and Catra saw something.

It could’ve been the expression she was wearing, or just the tears that were reflected by the campfire, but it made Catra’s own flames stifle.

Unprompted, she kept her company.

The fire crackled softly, the only thing that made her feel less lonely many nights before Catra was in her life.

‘Before my… my kind of grandma-’ She inhaled and exhaled through her mouth. ‘She told me I was a first one. With the sword I could’ve-’ Adora put her head towards her knees and put her hands through her hair. ‘I was too late. Just in case… I don’t want to be too late again.’

Catra shuffled closer to Adora and put one hand on her knee.

***

On their way to their next adventure, Catra and Adora came upon another civilisation. Catra translated the here and bouts of what

they said.

She could also remember them from so many years ago, and was kind of surprised how much had stayed the same.

That night, Catra and Adora were dancing with them, an ode to the moon and a prayer of the stars.

Looking at the people, and then at Catra, sharing laughter between them two.

Adora didn't feel all that lonely anymore.

***

Going up to the North pole, they stopped at one of Adora's favourite places. They were still far from the North pole, but they had made some progress.

Adora had taken Catra's hand, wanting to show her something.

The trees, the sounds and the smell were all so familiar.

They only stopped when seeing a sort of palace like structure, in the midday.

'What is this?' Catra had asked.

Adora took a deep breath and spread her hand out for Catra to see. 'This, is home.'

That day, they had climbed the palace to look at the sunset. Catra putting her head on Adora's shoulder, and Adora putting an arm around her.

A lot of things had changed this year.

A lot of things had also changed before that.

Only, this time, it was for the better.

***

The North pole wasn't very welcoming. It's landscape barren and cold. So much so, that Catra decided to stay in her lamp again.

Oh, and did she mention slippery?

It was.

Very.

Walking on what she presumed was ice, she slipped.

The ground cracked beneath her and she was met by cold water. This was it as she couldn't find the place where she fell through.

She had it good, for a long while, and she cherished her bond with Catra. One of her last thoughts was about what she could have, if she ever took the chance.

***

Laying in the sand again, she felt a pressure beating on her chest. She spluttered the water out.

She was… alive?

In front of her, Catra was panting. 'Please don't ever do something like that again. This time it was really close! I only noticed it after a while, and I can't bring people back to life!' Catra's hand had moved up to Adora's face, caressing her cheek and sniffling. 'Please never scare me like that again, okay?'

Adora put her hand on top of hers. She moved her face to kiss the palm of Catra's hand. Catra talked again, her voice filled with emotion. 'Please choose for yourself one time in your life.' She put a stray hair back behind Adora's ear. 'What do you want, Adora?'

'I want to be with you.'

Their foreheads touched, and they kissed. Conveying all that they needed, and should have said a while ago.

For the first time in a long time, Adora could imagine her having a future.

And most of all, a home again.

Chapter End Notes

oops, not me writing an almost 2k fic that most people won't ever read because i put it in this mega fic

btw, this was deffo inspired by aladdin, but gayer

Party kisses

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Prompt: "That was not my intention."

***

'Hey, nice costume!'

'You too!'

Adora couldn't believe it. She went as Caitlyn from Arcane to a Halloween party and in front of her is a *hot ass* looking woman in Vi's one. She feels the corners of her mouth raise up a bunch.

What are the odds?

She leaned in so she doesn't need to shout over the loud music and extends her hand. 'I'm Adora.'

'Catra.'

'I guess we need to stick together now. It's like faith.'

Sure, Adora went with Bow and Glimmer, but they've got their own couple's costume.

Ánd they both ditched her in the first five minutes they could. Bow, ever the social one, got swept up in conversation. She knows how hard it is for him to say no. And Glimmer… Glimmer went straight to the booze. Adora would've followed her, but her eyes spotted Catra. By the time she looked back in the direction that Glimmer went in to, she couldn't find her.

Besides, this was a *really* cool Vi costume.

One of Catra's eyebrows quirked up. 'Don't you think I have something better to do, cupcake?'

Adora gapes. She felt the muscle that holds up her jaw slack, as her mouth opened in shock. What does that even mind?

Catra looked at her, her face stoic.

That was, until her smile broke through, a light and squeaky sound came out.

It was beautiful.

'I'm just messing with you. Want something to drink?'

Adora needed to process it all, because she was pretty sure that she just got a whiplash. The last words of Catra's sentences reached her brain and she could process it, finally. 'Yeah, let's go!'

Her arm pumping in the air may have been an overkill, but hey. She was stoked.

They walked towards the kitchen that was less packed than the dancefloor. Maybe it was because you could actually hear each other speak, over the dimmed music.

Catra opened the fridge, that was decorated by a paper pumpkin and spider, both held up by some magnets. Adora wouldn't have dared to just open the fridge at a random party, but her counterpart looked quite comfortable in doing it.

'You want a beer?' she pointed one towards Adora, its condense still on the bottle.

'No thanks, I'm driving.' And what a good thing it was. The last thing Adora needed was to let a cute girl meet drunk Adora.

Or anyone, to be exact.

Catra put the bottle back and pulled out two soda's. She opened them both at the same time by smashing the caps against each other.

She handed one over to Adora and raised the other one in the air. 'Cheers!'

'Cheers!'

***

Glimmer remembered about an hour into the party that she went here with Adora, too.

Shit, she thought.

Somehow, in the past thirty minutes, she'd swept Bow away to dance together. It wasn't that easy, considering how every which way they turned, there was a familiar face. At least for Bow.

Adora was probably distracted by a dog or something. A natural occurrence for her to do at parties.

She probably was fine, otherwise she'd send a text.

Anyhow, Adora became some of the last of her worries as she exchanged lovingly whispers with Bow.

As friends... Of course.

But Glimmer was working on that.

Anyhow, slow dancing in Bow's arms even though the music was anything but, she was reminded of Adora.

By seeing her. And not alone, even so far as *making out* with a girl? Good for her.

Glimmer nudged Bow, and he also looked.

'Holy shit, isn't that Catra?'

Her relaxed state changed fast. ‘Wait, Catra as in my mortal enemy from the debate team in high school Catra?’

He nodded. ‘I think so.’

That was all it took for her to yank Bow along the room, and tap Adora on the shoulder.

***

High on endorphins, Adora was confused by the feeling of tapping on her shoulder.

Who in their right mind would ever interrupt people making out? That was like waking up sleeping dogs, or babies or something.

She looked up and, oh. Glimmer, with Bow standing awkwardly behind her. That made sense.

Although, she was pretty sure that it wasn’t time to go yet.

Glimmer also seemed to be mad at something. Nothing to be worried about, drunk Glimmer was like that.

‘Hey Sparkles.’ Catra said, still in Adora’s arms.

Her teeth clenched as she said, ‘Catra.’ She then pointed at Adora. ‘I told you to never become friends with her!’

Adora’s eyebrows raised through the sky. ‘Wait what?’

‘She was that one bitch from the debate team. And you’re even matching! That’s even *worse*!’

Adora put her hands in front of her. ‘I didn’t even know who the famous ‘bitch from debate was’! We didn’t go to the same high school and you’ve never told me her name!’

‘And you were even kissing with her!’

‘That was not my intention!’

‘It certainly looked like it was.’ Catra, who let the scene play out before her, finally chimed in again. Just to be a tease, Catra tightened her hold on Adora, almost predatory.

‘You!’ she pointed at Catra. ‘And you!’ she pointed at Adora. ‘Keep it in your pants!’

‘Okay, that’s *definitely* not my intention.’

Glimmer stormed away to calm down. Bow looked at Adora and she understood. Drunk Glimmer was something else, but Bow was always the one who could magically keep her level headed.

She stood eye to eye to Catra again, who had a smirk on her face. She quirked one eyebrow in a challenge. ‘So, *cupcake,* tell me more about your... intentions.’

A smirk played on Adora’s lips, just seconds before she dived back in again to kiss Catra. Her palms found their place against Catra’s hips, her fingers splayed out on her ass. She squeezed once, and Catra made a small sound.

It gave Adora enough access to put her tongue in her mouth. Catra’s hands found their way into Adora’s hair and she tugged lightly. She tried to stifle the noise that *she* let out, but it was all in vain.

Yeah. Adora was glad she came.

Chapter End Notes

tomorrow's chapter will be way shorter!

Toddler Catradora

Chapter Notes

> if you don't know what i mean with 'brick sorter', i mean this thing

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Prompt: "How would that even work?"

***

Mara sat on the couch in the living room, watching how Adora and her friend were playing. Even though they were young, whenever they got together they were little troublemakers.

Well, as much as you could say that about two toddlers.

At least they were inseparable together, that much seemed to be clear. Whenever Catra leaves, Adora's always gushing about how much fun it was with Catra, because *'She has toys! I have toys! Together we have more!'*

Even now, they're sharing. Catra brought something new. Catra's mom told Mara before she went, that Catra's unable to part with her new brick sorter.

The first thing that Mara was greeted by that day was therefore Catra holding the box up.

'Look at the colours!' she said, her tiny arms barely reaching Mara's upper leg.

Right now, she's saying something similar to Adora, explaining in full detail how it all works.

Adora is nodding dutifully, cherishing each piece information as if it was a secret.

‘And you can put all the bricks here!’ Catra pointed at square hole.

Adora picked up a small cylinder and studied it with all her might. She looked at the square hole again. ‘How would that even work?’

‘I’ll show you!’ One tiny hand grabbed the cylinder and she pushed it through the square hole. ‘See?”

‘You’re magic!’ And with that, Adora’s flailing arms came around Catra, the force made them both lay down on the floor in a fit of giggles.

If Mara was sure about one thing, it was that those two will be together forever.

Chapter End Notes

cuties

Flea bad, flee bath

Chapter Notes

please appreciate the title, thank u

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Prompt: "No, anything but that."

***

Catra scratched the back of her neck.

She was itchy all over, ever since that stupid mission on a stupid bug planet.

It sucked ass.

She couldn't believe even thinking it, but the worst thing about it was Adora.

Don't get her wrong, she loves Adora with all her might and more. If somebody even looks at Adora the wrong way, they deserve to feel Catra's.

But no, the thing is, Adora was persistent.

Really persistent.

If you had to name two qualities of Adora, it was determined and persistent. Those things are basically the same, but that only shows how much being determined and persistent intertwines with the whole of Adora.

Yeah, Catra loved all of Adora, and will be loving all of Adora for longer than you can imagine.

But Catra didn't have to like the persistence when it came to this one thing.

‘You should really take a bath.’ Adora said for the tenth time already, this hour.

She knew she shouldn’t have scratched the back of her neck in Adora’s vicinity. And her ear, while she’s at it.

‘No I don’t.’ She purposefully looked somewhere at the wall. She was not going to cave for Adora’s pouty face.

‘Pleaseeeee?’

‘No Adora. Just get my back for me, will yah?’

She turned her back to Adora and she heard her footsteps.

She felt her presence behind her.

But why didn’t she get that sweet relieve on that one spot on her back?

‘Adora?’

She heard a sigh from her girlfriend. ‘This is the last time.’

As if. She’s been saying that for a week already. Catra hummed in fake agreement.

‘Because you really need a bath.’ Adora continued.

‘I don’t think so.’

‘Just one flea bath! To get the fleas off!’

‘Adora! I love you, but knock it off, okay?’

She scratched the spot on Catra’s back, and what a *relief* it was. After that, Adora huffed and walked away.

***

‘Pleaseeee, Adora?’ Catra was above begging. This wasn’t begging, but it was close. Desperate times call for desperate measurements, what can she say?

‘No, Catra. You’ve heard my conditions.’ Adora’s normally soft looking eyes were hardened from the cold radiance coming from her own face. ‘I’m serious Cat! Just *one* bath with Entrapta’s anti-flea serum, and I’ll scratch you wherever you want!’

Catra was about to open her mouth, but Adora was faster. Putting one finger up in Catra’s face. ‘Don’t even.’

‘Adora, I really don’t need it!’

‘Don’t be stubborn, you need it!’

‘No, anything but that. I’ll never, not in a million years get into that bath with a weird ass *potion* that Entrapta made! Even the thought of it is ridiculous!’

Adora clenched her teeth and glared at her girlfriend.

***

‘I hate this.’ Catra folded her arms.

‘And I’m proud of you.’ Adora gave her a kiss on the forehead from where Catra was sitting in the bathtub.

‘You’re lucky I love you.’

A smile appeared on Adora’s face. ‘I really am.’

If it wasn’t for her love, she probably wouldn’t be sitting here, but when Adora wanted to sleep on the couch tonight, she knew it was over. They haven’t slept a day apart since they were together again and they want to keep it like that.

And it wasn’t as if the fleas liked humans, or anything without fur really. That much was clear when she looked at the lucky bastards

that called themselves best friends squad. They all came back with exactly *nothing.*

Oh well.

The serum that Entrapta made seemed to help, or just the fact that she was underwater. She didn't feel itchy all over.

'See, it isn't that bad, right?'

Catra only grumbled.

Of course did Adora need to chuckle at that, not even letting Catra be moody in peace. Her smile always did too much wonders to lift her mood.

'Come on, Catra. We can take a bath together after this? You're already wet.' Adora saw again how Catra wanted to say something, and again she was met by Adora's finger in front of her face. 'Don't.'

She closed her mouth again. Needing to uphold a reputation, she rolled her eyes. 'Fine.'

***

The second time she was in a bath in short succession was way better. Laying in Adora's arms, who was sighing in contentment and every so often pressed kisses in Catra's neck, Catra thought that taking a bath wasn't all too bad.

Chapter End Notes

Sorry for the late update! Life hits sometimes, and sometimes was today

Rest's back with a back rest

Chapter Notes

> im genuinely sorry for these chapter titles, and it's only the 6th one

Prompt: "Adaptable, I like that."

***

'It's here!' Catra calls.

'What?' Adora walks from her home office to the front door. Her back is screaming in protest, so she needs to walk while slightly leaning forwards. She's met by the sight of her grinning girlfriend and a… package? 'What's that?'

'It's a present for you!'

Adora hasn't asked for a present. And she thinks she'd remember it if her birthday suddenly changed.

Fuck… was it their anniversary?

No. She would never forget the wonders that happened on the 15th of May.

'But why?'

Catra walks up to her and kisses her. How could something she's done so many times before still feel so wonderful? Adora sighs into the kiss.

Her girlfriend puts her hands behind Adora's neck. 'Because you deserve it.'

***

Adora is not allowed to look at what it is, so Catra builds it on her own in the living room. She returned to her home office, still needing to look at some reports for her work.

A part of her is glad she isn't needed, because with the stinging in her back that started to flare up two weeks ago, she isn't sure if she would have been that much of a help.

Another part is also sad that she couldn't help, but Catra sounds happy and content, whistling through the walls as she puts the mystery package together.

A knock graces her door. 'Yeah?'

She stands up from her chair to open the door, wincing ever so slightly again, but Catra beats her to it.

'It's done.'

They walk towards the living room and the anticipation is building in Adora.

She looks and its… a chair! Another one? She got a new chair not too long ago from Perfuma. A new kind of chair that should stimulate your reiki flow or something. Adora wasn't really listening at the time. Perfuma's voice is perfect to drift off to.

Something she's doing right now. Only, Catra's '*Ta-da!'* and jazz hands, a quirk she stole from Adora, is bringing her back.

Adora is shook, but her girlfriend nudges her some more. 'Go on. Sit on it!'

And Adora does it.

She doesn't think her glutes have ever been this comfortable. She tries one of the levers underneath the seat. It changes the backrest and her back rests for the first time since ever. 'Adaptable, I like that.' She tries not to tear up at her thoughtful

girlfriend. ‘I love it!’ She stands up and pampers her girlfriend with kisses on her face.

In between kisses Catra manages to say ‘We should donate your other chair. I think it gives you those back pains.’

Now that she thinks about it, that could be right. They did get thát chair around the same time as when her back started to hurt.

Adora puts her head on Catra’s and hums. For good measure, she also gives her a kiss on her hair.

Win some, lose some

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Prompt: "Check that again, are you sure?"

***

'Are you ready?' Catra asked, sitting in the chair next to Adora, their dinner table in front of them.

Adora nodded. 'Born ready.'

Catra grabbed the coin of the table and held it in the air like a hero would do with a sword. In a way, the object in her hands was just as important in what was about to happen.

She put it in Adora's hand, their fingers brushing at the passing over.

Adora looked up above, but closed her eyes. 'Please, please, please let it be good.'

She looked back down again at the lottery ticket in front of her. '*Get some money, honey!'* was printed on top of it. Adora wasn't sure if that was their slogan or their brand name. Either way, it didn't matter.

She shared one last look with her girlfriend.

'You know the deal, scratch four lucky clovers and make us rich, baby.'

A soft blush peppered Adora's cheeks, just like each time she did whenever Catra called her that.

She needed to ground herself for two reasons now, so she exhaled through her mouth. She made eye contact and nodded.

Adora looked at the ticket that was laying on their table. This was it. The coin firm in her hand, she began her mission. The first section revealed a clover. Not too bad, but pretty much worthless if not multiplied by four.

She continued and… Another clover.

A good start, Adora thought, *but I don't want to get my hopes up.*

For the next one, she took more of her time. She started on the outside of the section, creeping in on the symbol ever so slightly.

A peak of green revealed itself.

That could mean anything though, there were a lot of green things in life. Like, leaves, paint and the clover she was met by.

Oh.

A part of Adora was dying to know what the last section revealed. She hadn't even entertained the idea of becoming a millionaire, but now that she might have a chance…

It wouldn't hurt them, financially speaking. She didn't care if Catra and her were rich or anything, she'd love her in every universe, but a million dollars. A million whopping dollars would be, *purely theoretically speaking*, very nice and have a significant impact on her day to day.

Then she'd take Catra out on a nice dinner, at the fanciest restaurant they could think of.

She could afford that, then. What she can't afford now though, is to get her hopes up like that.

'Last one.' Adora she says to Catra. Her eyes are locked with the uncovered section, that could change their life's in just a scratch of a coin.

She closes her eyes. She can’t take this. ‘Could you tell me the symbol?’

‘Of course, princess.

That’s all the push she needs to scratch the last one. It’s silence at first, and Adora wonders if she Catra can even see the symbol.

The seconds stretch on, but the coast doesn’t feel clear.

‘No way. It’s a clover.’

Adora’s blood starts to flow like crazy. There’s no way they’ve just won a million dollars like that. ‘Check that again, are you sure?’

She has to see this for herself.

When she opens her eyes, she’s greeted by four clovers.

She turns to her girlfriend and shakes her by the shoulders before hugging her from her place on the chair. ‘We did it!’ She squeezes Catra extra tight for a second.

At first, Adora was sceptical and confused about why Catra wanted to try a lottery. She hasn’t ever expressed real interest in that, always saying that stuff like that are a waste of money. But it paid off.

Adora pulls away from the hug, taking Catra in who’s smiling like crazy now. Her grin from side to side.

Only it falls apart in laugher. ‘You should’ve seen your face!’

What in the hell is Catra talking about right now?

The sound of her laughter still bouncing through the room, Catra regains more of her breath. ‘It’s fake.’ Adora swears there are tears of laughter in the corners in Catra’s eyes. ‘It even says so on the back.’

Adora picks up the ticket. Indeed, it says that it's a fake. Her brain still needs to catch up with what just happened. 'So... We didn't win a bunch of money?'

'No can do, chief.' Catra wiped the last tears from her eyes, her mirth dimmed down to silent giggles. She stood up from her chair, only to sit in Adora's lap. Both of her legs are dangling on the sides of the chair. She pecks Adora on the lips. 'You've been pranked.'

Adora can't find it in her to be mad. Catra's happiness always cheers her up.

All in all, it was too good to be true anyway.

Still, she pouts for the dramatic effects. 'That's mean, Cat.'

'Oh yeah? Think about that the next time you'll sign me up for *ten* different email listings.' Catra moves forward to kiss her again. How could she not, when Adora's so damn close that she can feel the warmth radiating off of her. 'Or when you put my hair diffuser on the highest shelve.'

Adora chuckles at the memory of that. Catra was too stubborn and prideful to ask for help. 'That's because you're beautiful without any of that.' Catra rolled her eyes. Adora was always such a sap. 'The other one was because *you* were the one who told me you hid three of my dumbbells but you actually only hid two, and you know it.'

Catra hummed and leaned in again, this time savouring their kiss a little more. 'Well, just know that it's on, babe.' She grabbed something out of the back of her jean pocket. 'I did get you a consolidation price.'

When Adora could get a closer look, she saw that it was another ticket. This time, she read the back of it. She wasn't about to fall for the same prank twice, but this one seemed legit.

She grabbed the coin again, scratched all the sections without suspense, and checked the prize. ‘Fifty dollars.’

‘Damn, babe. I think I’ll quit my job now.’

Adora huffed. ‘As if you’ll get any of this. This is the price you’ll pay for the emotional damage you gave me.’

Catra hummed and leaned in to kiss again.

And again.

Until they were full on making out.

Adora didn’t know if it was an attempt to change her mind, but it didn’t work anyway.

She was going to treat Catra dinner anyway.

Chapter End Notes

And, that's a week of fictober

September. In October?

Chapter Notes

If you don't know September by Earth, Wind & Fire, here it is!

Prompt: "Do you remember?"

***

Adora barged into the apartment, shocking Catra who was eating her cereal on a peaceful Saturday.

Well, peaceful before Adora came barging in, of course.

Her girlfriend was out of breath, as if she had sprinted instead of jogged on her daily run. Now that she thought about it, she was earlier back than usual. Her hair was a tiny mess and one of her earbuds was dangling loose.

'I messed up.'

'What you do?' Catra put her spoon down in her bowl.

'Catra, I really messed up!' Adora began to pace around in the tiny kitchen, yanking her earbuds loose and putting them on the dinner table. Each new word that came from her mouth only seemed to accelerate. 'I was running and then a song came up and I really messed up!'

'Hold on, what song? What happened?' It's been a while since she saw Adora this worked up about something. It seemed important to Adora, so Catra did her best to follow.

'That one with the *"Do you remember? The 21st night of-"* September! That was the name!'

Catra nodded. 'And what's up with that?'

‘It’s October 8th! I wanted to dance with you-‘ Adora did some mental math, using her fingers to count. ‘-*eighteen* days ago! But I forgot, Catra.’ She looked down at the ground and her nicely shaped eyebrows frowned.

‘It’s okay, ‘Dor.’ She stood up from her chair and walked over. She wrapped her arms around Adora’s neck. ‘We can dance right here, right now.’

‘But that’s less iconic. Now I can’t ask you if you remembered dancing in September.’

Catra raised one of her hands to cup Adora’s face. Sometimes, she wondered what was going on in her girlfriend’s brain.

At least it was charming. Sure, it was silly at the best of times, but it’s one of the many reasons that made her fall in love with her.

‘We can pretend? That it’s September.’

She grabbed Adora’s hands and guided them to her waist, before putting her hands behind Adora’s neck again. She started swaying a bit, in rhythm of a non-existent beat.

‘I’m sweaty and gross though.’ Adora pouted.

‘I don’t care.’

That was all Adora needed to wrap her close. So close that they were pressed flush together and they started to gently sway left and right.

It was moments like these that Adora realised that Catra was thé girl of her dreams.

‘Cat?’

She hummed in response.

‘I really love you.’

‘I really love you too ‘Dor.’

In for a loop

Chapter Notes

Early update today? I know, I was surprised too

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Prompt: "Sounds like a you problem."

***

'What got you so down?'

The moment Adora walked in, she looked on the verge of crying. She kept looking like that when she put the groceries in their rightful place.

It was only that Adora started *sniffing* while putting a carton of milk in the fridge, that Catra decided that Adora made her business, Catra's.

Adora closed the fridge, but didn't look away from it or turn her body to Catra. Her voice broke, saying the next words. 'They don't sell *Rainbow Friendship Crunchy Loops* anymore . I've looked in every store.'

'Ha! I was wondering when they'd check the health regulations for that one.' The natural sugars in combination with the synthetic additives didn't seem very legal.

Adora made fists from her hands and clenched and unclenched them. 'They're my favourite. And they don't sell them anymore.'

'I won't lie to you, but... Sounds like a you problem.'

Adora sighed. 'I know.'

And she walked away without muttering another word.

Nothing.

Catra hoped that she'd feel better tomorrow.

***

Turns out that Adora was weirdly passionate about her cereal, directed at a younger age group.

She was poking with a fork in a bowl of overcooked eggs.

Better than undercooked eggs, Catra supposed.

But she didn't look up when Catra walked in. She wasn't greeted with the usual 'Good morning, Catra!'

It felt off in every way to see her so… down.

Catra could deal with the silence, but the worst thing of all…

Adora wasn't smiling.

Catra had, in all the time that she knew Adora, never seen her go a day without smiling.

If it was up to Catra, she'd make that fact true as soon as possible again.

***

Adora was back from college, backpack slung over one shoulder. How could one minor thing impact her this much?

Sure, she'll get through this. She's a big girl, after all. Hell, she's an adult. It was only just a tiny bit unsettling feeling like this. Her movements were sluggish and she'd more often than not wondered today if she'd gained fifty years in one day.

Punching her feelings out also wasn't an option anymore, since Adora felt nothing for it without her hype breakfast. Some people drank coffee in the morning, but Adora ate her breakfast.

In short, she wasn't feeling it without her *Rainbow Friendship Crunch Loops.*

Her jacket and shoes off, she walked closer to the kitchen. In there, Catra was sitting.

Past, happy Adora would've chatted with her.

This version of herself wanted to be alone for a little while.

She probably needed to maintain human contact, but that could wait, right?

Apparently not, as Catra, to her surprise, spoke to her.

***

'Adora?' Catra knew that is was getting bad. Ignoring Catra at breakfast was one thing, but not telling excitedly about her say was another. She kind of yearned to see Adora excited like that again.

Not that she'd ever admit that.

Anyhow, Adora was always ready to help people. Even now, when she looked like she went through literal shit.

She walked and leaned on the counter, giving Catra the tiniest nod ever.

Okay, Catra was a bit nervous before, but this didn't help either.

Fake it 'till you make it.

She walked over to lean on the counter next to Adora and crossed her arms. *All for acting casual,* she thought.

'Could you get me some chips from the pantry? It's all the way in the back.' Their pantry just had to be one of the upper cabinets. Catra could reach it, and often was too stubborn to ask for help

when she couldn’t. Adora then teased her for having to stand on a chair to reach something.

But Adora didn’t tease her for being short.

There was just a good bit of nothing, again.

Adora opened the pantry, and Catra could see the exact moment that she noticed what was standing there.

Her whole body perked up, instead of the slump she was wearing these past days.

The first thing she did too, was turn around and look at Catra at lightning speed.

‘Is that...?”

‘Your dumb cereal? Yes.’

In the pantry were not one, but *three* packs of it. All of them sporting the familiar idiot alicorn on the box.

Adora grabbed one of the boxes and hugged it close to her chest. She went as far to give it a kiss on top. ‘But... How? I’ve searched everywhere!’

‘Yeah, well, apparently not.’

And there it was again. Adora’s usual happy demeanour.

You can’t be always positive, but Adora came close.

Catra’s happy to see that back again.

‘Did you... Did you do this for *me?*’

‘Don’t be ridiculous, Adora. I just saw them laying around.’

‘But where though?’

Catra bit her lip and looked away. She didn't want to tell her.

One quick glance at Adora threw soot in her plan. The hopeful look made her cave.

'...frightzone.'

'You went all the way to *Frightzone?* Just to get me some cereal?'

Yeah, if you say it like that, it does sound kind of dumb.

The smirk Adora wore, told her that she was feeling like herself again. They both knew what Adora would say, just about now.

'Catra... Do you *like* me?' and she nudged Catra with her own shoulder.

'No, it's not because I like you!'

'Then what was it about, hmmm?'

Maybe, Catra had made a mistake. Maybe she did like pouty and sad Adora more, than this absolute radiant imbecile, questioning Catra's whole being.

Adora looked a tad bit too smug though.

'Ugh. You were just so sad about it! You weren't wearing your usual dumb smile anymore.'

Exactly that dumb smile turned into a stupid dumb grin.

That was all the warning Catra got before getting swept into a hug. Adora held her so tight, it was a wonder that she could breathe normally.

All the teasing left her tone, for once. 'Thank you, Cat. Thank you.'

Too much feelings.

There were too much feelings, and there was too much sincerity in those few words alone, Catra couldn’t say anything anymore.

So, she did the next best thing, and patted Adora awkwardly on her back. ‘It’s all good.’

Adora moved a little back to look at Catra better. She really needed Catra to understand what this all meant to her. ‘I *really* appreciate it.’

‘Don’t worry about it.’ Catra said, softly. A smile played on her lips, against her will.

Adora pulled her in a hug again.

Chapter End Notes

> i know this is kind of similar to yesterday's fic, but i hope you can forgive me because of the 1k soft catradora content

Texting troubles

Prompt: "It's my name on the line."

***

'Glimmer?' Adora called from the living room.

'What?' she asked from her own room.

'Could you come here for a second?'

Glimmer groaned.

She did open her door though, her frame hidden by an oversized hoodie that she stole from Bow. 'It's like-'' she looked at her wrist and realized that she wasn't wearing a watch. Now that she thought about it, did she ever? '-way too early to wake me up.'

'It's seven over nine.'

'That's what I said!'

'Could you, maybe...' Adora had to look away. Asking for help was never easy, but she really needed it. 'Could you help me? With something?' She looked at Glimmer again. 'You can say no, don't feel pressured to help me!'

Those word combinations seemed to do the trick to shake Glimmer from her sleepiness.

Adora never, in the history of ever, asked for help.

'Yeah, of course! Anything. Anything at all!'

'Could you read this text?'

Glimmer massaged her temples. 'Hold on. You wake me up, at the crack of dawn to read a text?'

‘Yeah, I... I want to finally text Catra and I’m just not sure? If it’s too much...?’

Adora had spent the last two days overthinking. Ever since she Catra put her number in Adora’s phone and joked to ‘text her if she wanted a date’. Today, she caved. Catra probably hadn’t meant it like that, but Adora wanted to at least talk to her again.

There were just some things she couldn’t do alone, though. Hence, Glimmer.

Her roommate sighed. Her feet barely lifting from the ground, she made her way to Adora and grabbed the phone.

‘Are you kidding me?’

‘No...? Is it that bad?’ Adora knew that she wasn’t the best texter, but… ‘Oh my god, what if I ruin my chances?’

‘You *woke* me up. For this.’

‘Well, yeah! It’s my name on the line.’ What if she sends the wrong thing and Catra decides that she didn’t want her? Not that she thinks she has a chance... But still, fucking this up for herself would take away the slightest sliver of hope that she had left. Adora stood, standing next to Glimmer. ‘If it’s awful I can change it again! I’ve got ten different drafts in my notes, let me get them.’

Adora reached her hand to her phone, but Glimmer was surprisingly strong and held on for dear life. She squeezed so hard that the phone would leave imprints on her fingers.

‘No! Just fucking send this shit! It’s fine!’

‘What? I can’t do that if the shit is shit! Fine isn’t good enough!’

Adora yanked her phone finally out of Glimmer’s grasp.

But Glimmer couldn’t tolerate this. Today was one of the first days in a long time that she could sleep in, she hadn’t had her morning

coffee yet, and she was done with this bullshit.

All logical reasons that led to the following happening.

Glimmer tackled Adora.

Glimmer tackled her 5’6 roommate, that she’s known for about four months and three quarters.

The grasp on the phone loosened and Glimmer moved faster than a cheetah. Adora was screaming when she saw Glimmer lurching closer to her phone that had fell on the carpet.

Before she knew it, it was too late.

‘There!’ she’d sent the text. Glimmer gave the phone to Adora, who was still spread out on the floor.

‘She’s typing!’ In a split second she stood up again.

‘Oh my god, she’s typing!’ Glimmer screamed even louder, forgetting that it was indeed morning. ‘What did she say?!’

‘She’s still typing!’

And then Adora put her free hand on her mouth and squealed. She typed something back.

Glimmer stood on her toes to read what Catra had sent.

Catra <3

Hey! This is Adora :D (09:12)

(09:12) Hey Adora ;)

(09:12) i was already wondering if you changed your mind

(09:12) wanna go on that date

(09:12) this friday?

Yes!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!! :DDDDDDDDDDDDDDDDD (09:13)

Glimmer threw her hands up and walked away. She deserved some rest.

too gay to math

Chapter Notes

I thought that Catra as a cat would work better here, so yeehaw

Also,
CW: Shadow Weaver's bad parenting, math

Prompt: "Think! For once!"

***

Adora was with Shadow Weaver. Both were sitting at the dinner table, a paper in front of them.

'Come on, Adora. You can do this.'

'No, I can't.' She'd been trying all morning, and the panic inside of her had only increased.

'Adora, I see great potential in you. You're a smart girl and you can do great things.'

Oh, how Adora wished that was true. 'I'm not made for this.' Something prickled in the back of her eye.

Shadow Weaver's voice turned sweet. Sweeter than anything Adora had heard before. 'You can do it.' She pointed at the first question of the sheet of paper, for the seventh time that past hour. 'What's nine plus ten?'

Adora looked at Shadow Weaver. She didn't want to try anymore. What if it was wrong again. But Shadow Weaver gave her a nod to continue, so in a tentative voice, she said 'Twenty one?'

'You've been guessing all day, Adora! Think! For once!'

She bit her lip. '...twenty two?'

'Oh, you insolent child! I should've never-'

***

Adora woke up drenched in sweat. When was the last time she felt like this? As if her heart was replaced by a drugged hamster running in a tiny wheel.

She felt disoriented. Where was she?

She tried to take in the room, but her eyes were still a little unfocused. She blinked a lot.

The room she was in was familiar in all the best ways, meaning a long time away from Shadow Weaver.

A shudder ran through her body.

She was glad that that part of her life was over for good.

It's been a long time since she got a nightmare like this. Or well… a memory she dreamt about.

Shadow Weaver had nothing but praise for Adora… most of the time.

A great exception to that was math.

It wasn't that she *totally* didn't get it, it just wasn't her friend from time to time.

When she understood it, she liked it. But the likelihood of understanding it fast were… dim, to say the least.

Especially with Shadow Weaver looming over you, screaming.

She thought about another day when she was younger. She'd needed to learn fractions. It didn't end well. All the tears that

she'd cried, for *numbers*! That couldn't be normal! She could feel her jaw tense, and-

'Adora?' Catra said, her eyes glowing in the dark.

She looked down and saw her girlfriend laying next to her, her tail flicking underneath the blanket.

'Yeah?'

'You okay? You feel… tense.'

Adora unclenched her teeth, and lowered her shoulders. 'I had a nightmare.' She looked at Catra. 'About her.'

'Oh.'

Catra knew enough. She tried to resist the way her claws wanted to unsheathe. She moved to lay her body on Adora. The warmth and weight of Catra laying on her always grounded her. Still, Catra wanted to check in. 'Is this better?'

Adora put her arms around Catra and moved her hand underneath her shirt. She drew small circles on her back, feeling the soft fur. She leaned her head down to smell Catra, where her head was nestled in Adora's neck.

'Yeah, a bit.'

Catra began to rub her cheek against her neck. It tickled a tiny bit, but Adora always liked being marked. Catra moved her head to also mark Adora's face. Adora scratched her behind one of her ears and it made her purr.

With Catra here, Adora didn't need to think about the past, only about the future that they can spend together.

improv isn’t improvement

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Prompt: “You’re making my head hurt.”

***

‘And then, they did the whole scene just without words! I was trying to keep in my laughter to not distract them, but it was so funny!’ Glimmer screamed through the diner. Bow looked at his girlfriend with a lovesick smile on his face.

Catra looked at her own girlfriend instead, to look if they were on the same page.

Adora silently shook her head, unnoticed by the other two love birds.

Ugh, being nice was exhausting. Glimmer and Catra were finally finding a state of symbiosis were they could live in harmony together.

It was new, it was weird, but it was going okay.

Except that hearing Glimmer speak for a good *twenty minutes* about this new theatre improv class she was joining, really took the peace out of Catra’s day.

Deep breaths. Think of calming things like oceans, cats, Adora’s voice in the morning and-

And Glimmer tried to re-enact the scene she just described in great detail, about a vegetarian butcher in the stone age.

Too bad that it wasn’t true to that time period. Catra didn’t think that they talked all that much back then, or laughed that hard.

For real, though, how could one tiny person be that loud? Where did she get all the extra air she was using, to roar out in laughter.

Ugh. ‘You’re making my head hurt.’

Bow and Adora shared looks.

Oh no.

Glimmer’s laughter died down.

(Thank god.)

‘What did you just say?’

‘You know,' Bow started, ‘the weathers really nice today.’

‘Yeah, that’s true! The sun is shining and such.’ Adora, the traitor added, making a point of looking out the window.

Catra was someone with a spine, though, who stood for what she believed in. ‘I said, you’re making my head hurt with your bullshit. Improv doesn’t stand for improvement and it shows.’

Glimmer was for the first time that day fully silent. (Hallelujah.) She glared at her.

Catra glared back. She’s been training for this moment all of her life, it feels like.

The silent stretched on and Bow and Adora were playing charades. Catra would’ve loved to see the escape plans they came up with by using silent communication, but she couldn’t stop glaring at Glimmer.

That would mean defeat.

‘Hey, Catra, don’t we need to do some... Other stuff.’

‘No.’ she got out through clenched teeth.

‘And Glimmer, I believe the washing machine is almost done, maybe we should cut brunch short?’

‘We did laundry yesterday, because you wanted to show your new crop top.’

‘Oh, I was wondering if it was new! It really suits you Bow!’

‘Thanks Adora! I got it from a sale two days ago!’

‘Babe, maybe we should go there too!’ then Adora looked at Catra again, who was still glaring.

After temporary forgetting the battle Catra and Glimmer had, they remembered it all too well as it fell uncomfortably silent again.

That was, until Glimmer’s glare turned into a cheeky smile. ‘Damn, Catra! You’re glare is perfect! It really feels like you want to murder me. You need to teach me that for improv!’ Glimmer yelled through the diner again.

This time, Catra didn’t mind. ‘Sure, Sparkles. If you shut up about it for now.’ Her glare turned into a smile ‘I’m trying to eat without damaging my eardrums.’

Adora and Bow exchanged looks again.

What did just happen?

‘Anyway Bow,' Catra continued while eating a fry, ‘tell me where you got that top?’

Bow hesitated a moment before answering, making sure that Glimmer and Catra wouldn’t kill each other when he blinked.

Trying to get them to be civil to each other was weird in many ways, but it seemed to work. That’s all that Bow and Adora could ask for.

Chapter End Notes

i know this one was less catradora centered, but when i read 'you're making my head hurt' i could only think about catra saying this to glimmer

also, tomorrow's one will be more about catradora, so don't worry :P

catradora office job edition

Chapter Notes

i forgot to mention it yesterday, but this has become the longest fic on my page and im kind of proud of that

anyway, enjoy!

Prompt: "I don't want you to do that."

***

Catra was over the moon, to say the least. She was whistling going to work, and there was even a spring in her step.

When she got to the office, she even smiled at one of her co-workers. 'Hey Kyle, good morning to you!'

'Good... Morning Catra?' he side eyed her a couple of times and then subtly sprinted away.

Not that Catra would care about it, anyway, because nothing could break her stride.

Her backpack slung over her shoulder, she reached her desk and sat in her desk chair.

A press of a button started her work computer. As it was zooming to life, she unpacked her bag.

There, next to a bottle of water, lunch and papers (that she should unpack too), there were party hats, horns and an abundant amount party garlands.

It was a beautiful day after all, and time to celebrate.

Her awful supervisor finally got demoted! No more saltiness or passive aggression on the work floor! No more Weaver breathing

down her neck, complaining about stupid shit like the imaginary dust on her desk.

Her colleagues were probably also ecstatic about Weaver's leave.

With maybe one exception.

But that didn't matter. Catra had enough party hats for a life time. She went so far as to put one on already.

One of the many garlands, she pulled out of her bag. Her chair was the first victim to be decorated.

With the computer in front of her not forgotten, she began typing an email to all of her department.

Hey,

If you want to celebrate the demotion of Weaver with me today, I've brought enough stuff to celebrate properly. You can find me at my desk.

Catra

That'll do.

For good measure, Catra blew a party horn.

Feeling satisfied, she could get on with the day. There was work to be done after all.

She started up all the right programs. Their computers were fast, but sometimes it felt like not fast enough. It was mainly the fault of the outdated software, but Catra had hopes that they'll renew it very soon with the new department supervisor.

She felt a presence behind her. Would somebody also want a party hat? Catra turned within her chair and-

'What are you doing?' Catra was met by Adora Grayskull. Her co-workers and desk mate that sat across from her.

Generally speaking, Catra was right about a lot of things in her life. However, today she was wrong about at least one thing; that nothing could ruin her mood.

At first Catra didn't mind her deskmate, but then she realized that she was a suck up for Weaver. Always trying to be prim and proper. Catra was surprised about the fact that she hadn't seen Adora kissing Weaver's butt. Her real one, not the metaphorical kind.

'Celebrating Weaver's department.' Going for uber sarcastic instead of normal sarcastic, Catra blew the party horn.

'I don't want you to do that.' the stuck-up said, delivered with a steely gaze. Of course would Adora still respect Weaver's legacy and rules. My God, what a party pooper. But then her resolve broke and she added, 'without me!'

In a blink of an eye, Adora grabbed a party horn and whistled it so hard that Catra was surprised it didn't break. She then put, not one, but two party hats on and blew the party horn again.

'You're... You're not sad about Weaver leaving?' Catra needed to let it make sense in her head, because *what?*

If there was anyone who should be this happy about Weaver being gone, it should be her. Everyone in the whole office knew that she was Weaver's mental punching bag.

'Of course not! That bitch gone is good riddance!' Adora even went so far as to do a silly little dance.

Catra, in all of her life, hadn't ever heard Adora cursing. Ever.

Although, it was clear that she didn't know Adora as well as she thought she did.

Finally sitting down across Catra on her own desk, Adora sighed. She started her computer and said, 'haven't you checked your mail?'

It was the first thing she did when she sat down. 'Of course I ha-' her eyes fell onto the computer. There was one new notification. It was a reply to her own email.

Dear colleagues,

To further celebrate this event, I've brought cake. It's in the canteen and it's free to take. There's enough for everyone.

Kind regards,
Adora Grayskull

Well damn.

She looked at her desk mate, a smile forming in the corner of her mouth. 'I guess you're not all too bad, Grayskull.'

Adora gave her a smile back.

Winging it

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Prompt: "Yes. No. I don't know."

***

'Understood?' Glimmer said, hands clasped together as she stood next to Bow in front of Adora.

Adora nodded. 'Yes,' but the sure gesture slowly faltered and turned into the shaking of her head. 'No. I don't know.' The panic in Adora's voice increased with each word. They all had said so damn much in the last ten minutes, it all went over her head. 'Maybe explain it just one more time again?'

'Damn it, Adora! It isn't that hard! Just listen for once in you life, will you? I know you're capable-'

Bow put his hand in front of Glimmer. That, in combination with the look he gave her, shut her up real quick. 'Let me?'

'Fine.'

'Okay, Adora. We want to do something about the Catra situation. In short, I'll walk with you and absolutely wingman the hell out of you. That's it, that's all.'

This was just a mere example of why Bow needed to be the one who wingmanned her. He's likeable as hell.

The plan in itself wasn't too hard to grasp onto. Only, the nerves at just the thought of finally making a move on Catra were overflowing. She's talked to Catra before, that wasn't too hard.

Apart from the fact that every time they speak, Adora falls a little more for her.

Finally making a move on Catra, maybe even having a college love story? That tops it all. It's terrifying.

Absolutely terrifying.

Catra was a really cool person though. She wanted to shoot her shot.

Adora nodded once more. 'Okay. I'm ready.'

***

It was another day, and luckily, they had another break. Catra was walking with Scorpia around on campus towards their usual spot. 'Do you see her yet?'

'Not yet.'

Catra looked around again. 'You sure?' Adora isn't one to be late.

'Wildcat. Did you understand the plan?'

'Did I- Did I *understand* the plan? I wrote it!'

They reached their table and Scorpia stood directly in front of Catra. She put two hands on her shoulders. 'Then you can calm down. I'll tell you whenever I see her.'

'See who?' Bow's voice chimed in.

'Oh, there you are!'

There they were indeed. Bow and Adora.

And Adora was looking ethereal as always. Catra felt kind of gross being this sappy about a girl. Not just a girl though, the way Adora's eyelashes fluttered whenever she blinked had Catra pining since the moment she saw her.

She wanted to ask her out on a date. Catra was glad that Scorpia wanted to wingwoman for her, because seeing Adora is already taking her breath away.

She hadn't even noticed that Scorpia was already sitting down, just like Bow across from her.

Oh.

Catra was standing in front of Adora, taking her in, like a complete love-struck fool.

Wait, but what was Adora doing then?

'You guys can sit down too, if you want. Although I heard that sitting too much can be bad for you.' Scorpia said.

Adora and Catra went to sit.

Ugh, why was it suddenly so difficult to talk to Adora?

***

Adora was internally, freaking the fuck out.

'Hey Adora.' Catra said.

Ugh, how could Catra be so damn chill and casual all of the times. She was literally the embodiment of confidence right now.

'Hi.' That's it. That one word, Adora had said with the most chill she could muster. 'How you doing?'

Why was talking to pretty girls so hard?

Okay, talking with Catra went all right, most of the time. The only difference today was that Adora was filled to the brim with nerves.

Was it even worth it to ask Catra out, if she felt her insides tingle until it hurt from the anticipation?

‘I’m good, how are you?’

‘Also good.’

Bow and Scorpia sat next to them and witnessed this exchange. Bow tried his best not to cringe, but it was proving to quite challenging. He should intervene a little bit now... ‘So, there’s movie playing this Friday about a queer superhero group. Let’s watch it together?’

‘Yeah, that sounds like fun! A lot of fun!’ Scorpia added.

They both looked at Adora and Catra, who were looking at each other.

‘...sure?’ Catra said.

Adora looked at Bow and Scorpia again. ’Sounds cool.’

‘Oh wait, I forgot I can’t go!’ Bow pretended to sigh. ‘Too bad.’

‘Me neither. I have a...’ Scorpia looked above. Alas, she couldn’t find her fake-plans there. ‘...thing?’

‘Yeah, that thing. You’ve told me about it. Okay bye.’ That were the last words before Bow dragged Scorpia along to somewhere else, leaving Catra and Adora behind.

‘That was...’

‘Weirder than usual. I agree.’

‘Anyway... About that movie...’ Catra bit her lip. ‘You still wanna go?’

Adora tried her best to temper her excitement down. It didn’t work, obviously, but Catra didn’t notice over her own nerves. ‘Yeah! Definitely.’

The hang out was secured, but Catra had to push it further. They’ve hanged out before, but Adora needs to know her intent.

‘It’s a date?’

Adora’s breath caught. ‘As in, a *date* date?’

‘If you want it to be.’

‘I do.’

Now both Catra and Adora were beaming brighter than sunlight. The tell-tale signals were their humongous smiles and the gleams in their eyes. Over the table Adora reached for Catra’s hand, and held it for the rest of the break.

Chapter End Notes

> im glad i could post this because i literally have -4 minutes now
>
> okay bye, cya tomorrow

i'll be bio side 'till the end of time

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Prompt: "What are you doing?"

***

Entrapta was listening to some music, when she heard a knock. Hmmm… maybe she could work on making her headphones noise cancelling? Catra had said some stuff about it being a hazard to everybody involved, but nothing could be better than *science*.

'Log, make headphones noise cancelling.' She said in her recorder. It did catch the noise of someone knocking on the wood again. That was kind of annoying.

Entrapta opened the door to the apartment. 'Adora. Could you stop knocking?'

'Sure… I don't need to knock anymore.' Adora tried to take a peek at the other side of the door. In her hands was an object wrapped in gift paper. A present, perhaps. 'Is Catra home?'

A couple of things connected in Entrapta's head. 'No. Is that for Catra?'

'…yeah. I wanted to give her something.' She looked down at the wrapping paper, that looked like marble. 'I can come back later though.'

Adora moved to walk away. 'Wait!' And she turned back again, waiting for Entrapta to speak more. 'You can also wait here. Then I can do some experiments!'

Adora had met Entrapta only a handful of times, but she knew enough to know that this was in character for her. 'Aren't you

already doing experiments?'

'Yes, but now's the opportunity to do some on you!'

'Is that… is that really necessary?'

'Of course! Then I can determine if you're a good partner for Catra on a biological standpoint!'

'...do you think I'm a bad match for Catra?'

'I don't know! But I will, with *science!'*

Her throat felt dry, all of the sudden. Making a good impression on her girlfriend's was crucial.

And… a part of Adora wanted to know if she was right for Catra. She thought she was. A month didn't tell much, but it told enough, right? At least it was enough for Adora to know that Catra was the one for her.

If science could proof that she was also the right one for Catra… And if Entrapta, the smartest person Adora knew, approved of her as a partner… She couldn't pass up this chance, could she?

***

Adora wasn't at home like she usually was.

Not that Catra was obsessive, or something, but Adora always told her when she had a thing.

Gosh, that really sounded clingy, didn't it?

The neatly wrapped present sat in the passenger seat next to her. Catra had a whole car trip to start worrying about where Adora was.

Catra found out soon enough when she entered her apartment.

She hadn’t even fully walked into her apartment, when she was met by the sight of Entrapta shining a flashlight in Adora’s eyes.

‘What are you doing?’

Without looking up from the clipboard she was holding, she replied, ‘Science!’

Catra took her jacket and shoes off, and put her surprise gift on a table.

‘Let me clarify, what are you doing with my girlfriend?’

Entrapta had foregone the flashlight and got a measuring tape from one of her endless pockets. She put Adora’s arms in place, so she could measure Adora’s wingspan. She then noted some more values down on a clipboard, filled with incomprehensible scribbles.

‘Determining if she could be a good partner for you! She has perfect gums! And did you know that her finger length is optimal for-’

‘Okay Entrapta! That’s enough information.’

Looking at Adora’s blush, Catra knew she didn’t want to hear the rest of that sentence come out of the mouth of her friend.

‘Awhhh.’ Entrapta pouted.

Adora took that as a cue to stop imitating a statue, and walked over to Catra to embrace her. She also couldn’t resist it to give her a kiss.

‘Hey hot stuff.’

‘Hey princess. I was looking for you.’

‘Oh!’ Adora perked up again and grabbed her present. ‘I was also looking for you.’

A smile played on Catra's lips, and she grabbed her own present for Adora from the table. 'Here.' Catra took it in her hands for a second, and paused to look at Adora before carefully opening. Adora moved a hand to the back of her neck. 'I saw this in the store, and it reminded me of you, so I had to get you it.' Catra was at the point that she could see what was underneath the wrapping paper.

It was a pink snuggle plaid. A kind of blanket, but with a hood with cat ears on it. Maybe it was a bit silly, but Adora thought it was cute.

She could only hope that her girlfriend thought the same.

However, Catra was laughing and Adora didn't know if it was a good laugh or a bad laugh.

Catra also didn't say anything. Only grabbed something from a table.

It looked like a present, and Adora's brain caught up that it was for her.

At least, that is what she thought it meant when Catra put it in front of Adora's face and looked away a bit.

It was confirmed when Catra finally spoke again. 'I got you something too.'

Adora ripped the wrapping off and was met by-

'Awhh, Catra!'

She hugged her girlfriend tight.

Inside of the present was another snuggle plaid, but this one with dog ears. 'Now we're matching!'

Adora wasted no time to put it on. Catra tilted her head a little, taking her girlfriend in. Her girlfriend, who also nodded at the

blanket in Catra's hands.

She rolled her eyes, but she had a soft spot for Adora.

With the hood put over her head, they were truly matching.

Adora's face afterwards was worth it. She looked so entranced by seeing Catra with those silly cat ears on her head and she grabbed hold of Catra's waist.

Catra herself was entranced by the sight of Adora being entranced by her.

How could she not?

There were so many people on this big floating rock, and she met someone who looked at her as if she was the sole reason that the universe wasn't collapsing in on itself.

Adora made her feel special. Pretty and special.

And comfortable.

So *damn* comfortable.

And Adora wasn't afraid to be herself, even though she could be a silly goose from time to time.

Actually, most of her time.

But Adora is so much herself that Catra dares to be herself too, you know?

Adora was also so damn thoughtful.

It made Catra almost crazy.

How could she have met such a wonderful person, while the rest of the world hadn't.

Not that she was complaining. She wouldn't trade this for the world.

And things like these made Catra realise that they were not only on the same page, but on the same *line*.

It sounded cliché, because it was. Adora just understood her like nobody else.

Other people would think that it was too early, but with the way that Adora made her feel… She could tell her girlfriend three little words that mean a whole lot.

Catra opened her mouth, the confession laying on her tongue.

Instead she halted her breath a bit as Adora's eyes looked down at Catra's now open lips and back up again.

In the middle of October, when the days were supposed to be dark, Adora still had a glint in her eyes that lightened up the whole room.

Catra raised a hand up to put a stray hair of Adora back. She re-wet her lips, ready to tell her-

'*Fascinitaing.* Catra seems completely enamoured by Adora. Could it be that feelings have deepened in only one month? More research is needed.' Entrapta said in her recorder.

Adora had forgotten that she was there, honestly. By the way how Catra buried her head in Adora's shoulder and groaned, she thought it was fair to say that Catra had too.

She hugged her girlfriend tighter.

Whatever Catra was going to say, she'll probably come back on it later, right?

***

(Later that day they were snuggled up in their new blankets, legs on top of each other’s on the couch of Adora’s place. Catra threw some popcorn at Adora’s mouth and she caught it. Adora pumped two hands in the air in victory and laughed. Catra couldn’t contain it anymore and told her she loved her.

After Adora’s frozen state of shock wore of and she was melted by the warmth of the confession, she said it back.

When Catra returned to her apartment, it took Entrapta 0.3 seconds to guess what had happened.

It wasn’t that hard to guess, because Catra’s smile said it all.

Still, Entrapta appreciated that kind of data.)

Chapter End Notes

i thought this prompt would be around 700 words but it's that times two

whoops

Head in the clouds

Prompt: "You're looking, but you don't see."

***

'That one looks kind of like you.' Catra pointed at one of the clouds drifting through the air.

Adora and her were laying on a blanket in the grass, their belly's satisfied with the picnic food they've had.

Her girlfriend hummed for a moment, before glancing at Catra. 'Wait, where?'

She pointed again at the cloud in question. 'Right there.'

Adora moved closer to Catra, their heads almost touching. 'Oh! I think I see it? But it kind of looks like a chicken.'

'No, that one's there.' She pointed at another cloud, before letting her arm down again. 'You're looking, but you don't see.'

Adora wished she could see it. She wanted to know what part of the cloud looked like her. Adora did have more time to figure out which cloud Catra was eyeing, as today wasn't windy. It also made that the sun and the bright blue sky were blocked by the clouds, each a piece of art, free for everyone to look at.

She bit her lip, focusing on recognising shapes in the white blobs, but alas.

'I really can't see it.' Her eyebrows furrowed. Catra barely moved to kiss her cheek, because they were laying so close next to each other. 'I do see one that kind of looks like a clown?'

'That's the one!'

'Hey!'

Adora moved to lay on top of Catra, pinning her arms down with her hands. Her girlfriend could be such a brat sometimes.

'What, it's true!' Catra tried to get out while giggling. Adora's own smile wasn't far behind.

Adora only rolled her eyes and leaned in for a kiss.

Soon, it turned into many more. Adora moved her hands. With one, she held herself up and the other one reached to cup Catra's face, all while kissing. Catra's hands gripped at the back of Adora's shirt.

Adora tried to pull away. She wanted to see Catra under her, her curly hair fanned out over the ground, but she couldn't. With every inch that she moved backwards, Catra moved back up with her.

When Catra decided that they had risen far enough, she pulled Adora back down and used the momentum to get the upper hand. She was now laying on top of Adora.

Adora gasped.

Catra had gotten so much already and she got even more as that gasp allowed her to explore Adora's mouth. She knew it like the back of her hand, but that didn't stop her to take in Adora's lips again, which were unbelievable soft. Or her warm tongue that was trying to fight Catra's.

One of Adora's hands moved to the nape of Catra's neck, right there where her baby hairs started.

When Adora scratched there, it felt *so good* that Catra couldn't focus on kissing anymore. Their kisses turned slow until they stopped. To not lose contact, their foreheads where plastered together. Neither of them had opened their eyes, still panting after that hefty make out session.

Catra opened her eyes first. She was met by the sight of Adora, eyes closed and biting her lip. She let her lip go and opened her eyes.

God, Adora was pretty.

'Maybe we shouldn't do this in public.'

Catra fake-pouted. 'Awh, why not? Not up to your standards, princess?'

'Oh it sure was. But I don't think I have the self-restraint to stop if we go on.'

That was a very valid point. '*Fine*.'

She moved to lay next to Adora again, this time with her head on Adora's arm. She cuddled closer and felt Adora drawing small circles on her arm.

Catra hummed in content and looked up above. Maybe she could find her cloud-self too, today.

After all, she had her head in the clouds.

Bow is sweet, car go yeet

Chapter Notes

We've reached over 1000 hits! Whoop whoop!!!!!!

Prompts: "Are you serious?"

***

'Okay, but would you hit Catra for a million dollars?'

Adora didn't want to give Glimmer a knee-jerk response, so she really thought about it. She needed to be exceptionally careful, because Bow was there too, looking at her with his big doe eyes.

Yeah, there were definitely having an argument and Glimmer was trying to prove her point.

'Well, I'd-'

'Deffo.' Catra's voice came from behind her and she smacked her ass. 'Can I get a million now?'

Adora rolled her eyes. Catra always knew how to make an entrance. 'She didn't ask *you.'* Her hand touched Catra's nose to accentuate the 'you'. Then she wrapped an arm around her anyway. 'Where were you, slow poke?'

'I had Weaver. You know how she's always yapping about bullshit.' That much was true. With that, they walked towards their usual lunch spot.

'Okay, but Catra would slap Adora for a million, right?'

'Your point isn't proven yet.' Bow said, as he sat down.

'Okay, but it will be in just a second. Catra?'

‘Wait, why don’t you want my answer anymore.’ Adora looked a little bit sad.

‘Because Catra knows what’s up.’ Glimmer said. She looked at Catra. ‘Would you hit Adora with a car for a million dollars.’

‘In this economy? Bitch, yes.’

‘Are you serious?!’ Bow took a big gulp of air, while Glimmer was celebrating. He decided to breathe his air out, but not in silence. ‘Don’t you love each other? Real love isn’t measured in *money!* It’s irreplaceable! How could you even think about hurting somebody you love? And what about-‘

‘Calm down, Arrow boy. I’d just gently tap her with a car, inn the cash, and give her a sword or something.’

Adora was looking in silence at all three.

That was until Bow asked her a question. ‘And you would be fine with this?!’ His hand gestures were all over the place.

‘It would be that one sword that looked like She-ra’s, right?’ she made intent eye contact with Catra.

‘Duh.’

‘It’s a deal.’

Bow looked at how their friends shook on it and then kissed to seal the deal. He truly had more faith in them.

To make matters worse, Glimmer had to rub it in. ‘I told you so.’

‘Sorry that it’s such an exotic idea to not hit my girlfriend with a car.’

‘Don’t be a sore loser, Bow. It’s how real ballers work.’

Glimmer’s words would bounce around in his head for the rest of the day.

At least he knew who to call when that ultimatum became reality.

smitten kitten

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Prompts: "I don't think this is your problem."

***

'Meow.'

Adora almost dropped all the grocery bags she was holding and Catra's hand. She looked all over the place and looked at the street. Nothing special about that except some litter on the ground.

Did the sound came from a nearby building?

'Meow.'

There!

The sound came from an alley.

Adora ran towards it and tugged Catra along with her.

Underneath a dumpster, she saw two glowing eyes. Adora squatted to be closer to the ground and held out her hand. She tried to coax the cat closer by making sounds.

Surprisingly, it worked.

The cat slowly, cautious with every step, came forward from underneath the dumpster.

This wasn't a cat, it was a kitten.

A kitten with dark grey fur, that was matted at some places. They had bright blue eyes and a cute nose. With said nose, they sniffed

a little bit at Adora's outstretched hand and they meowed again. She turned back to look at her wife.

'Adora, no.'

'Adora yes.'

'Babe,' Catra started. 'Don't get too attached, please.'

Adora moved her hand to scratch the kitten behind it's head and they purred loudly.

Yeah, it was too late for that.

Adora jutted out her lower lip. 'But Catraaaah, I don't think they have a home.'

'And I don't think this is your problem.'

Adora tried to do her best puppy eyes while still petting the kitten. 'We can have a cat. We have enough space.'

They did have enough space. They were two people in a house. Not necessarily a big house, but big enough when you lived with two.

Still, it didn't take away the fact that Catra wouldn't be okay with a cat in their house. They were high maintenance. Catra tugged Adora up and away. 'We can't take every stray we see home, princess.'

With heavy steps, Adora followed her girlfriend home.

***

The next time they met the kitten, Catra and Adora wanted to go out for a walk in the mid-October air. The colours of the leaves were changing, so it was a great time to take in the world around them. All those colours made the trees look like their own seperate art pieces.

Catra had opened the door and saw the kitten. Adora looked ecstatic. Catra did not.

The first thing the kitten did was meow. 'They came back!'

'Great. They know where we live now.'

'Who's a good Swifty? You are. Yes, you are!' Adora was scratching the kitten behind their ears.

'You've *named* them?'

'…no?'

Catra scoffed. 'And *Swifty* of all things? You should've called them Melog or something.'

'Melog?' Adora asked, still petting the cat.

Oh no.

This was the day her mistakes caught up to her. She knew she couldn't rectify it when Adora's face turned into a smirk.

'Don't say anything.'

The only thing Catra could do was flee, so she did. She walked in the direction of a little park a couple of blocks down.

Her girlfriend wasn't left behind. She jogged a little bit to keep up. When she reached Catra, she put her arm around her waist.

'I like the name Melog.'

They heard another meow from behind them. They turned around and saw Melog swaying their tale gently from left to right.

Great. Now the kitten was following them.

'I think they like it too.' Adora said, looking at Melog.

***

Catra couldn't even enjoy a nice walk in the park with her girlfriend anymore. Adora kept looking at Melog.

She was cute though, her face lighting up every time when she noticed that Melog was still trailing behind them.

It was kind of weird that Melog did, though… Most cats lose interest, unless you-

'Okay, did you give them food or something?'

Adora was admiring Melog, who had laid on their belly, and froze completely.

(Why did Melog get attention for that? Catra could also lay on her belly, but *no*. Adora didn't look at her like she was the greatest thing that happened to her. She'd body-slam into her to join laying down, followed by falling asleep and partially drooling over Catra.

Not that she minded that… The weight of Adora sleeping on top of her made her feel safe. Her soft snores were also the best white noise one could ever wish for. In her sleep, Adora always, and Catra means *always* cuddles closer.

She's talked with Adora about it. She just responded that even her subconscious wanted to be close to her.

Catra did not blush at that.

Not.)

The way that Adora avoided Catra's gaze was proof enough.

'Adora!'

'It was only once!' She looked away at a tree when she mumbles, '…and then a couple times more.'

They didn't have cat food at their home.

How was this cat still alive?

Catra didn't wish Melog any harm, don't get her wrong, but Catra was seriously baffled to see Melog lick their paw as if nothing was wrong.

Adora couldn't even feed herself, let alone a cat.

'Did you feed them protein shakes?!'

'Just once! They didn't like that.'

'Because nobody likes those, excepts you!'

Catra loves her girlfriend very much, but this kitten couldn't stand between them.

***

'Meow.'

Today was the day. Catra was reading a book on the couch when she heard the little attention hoe ask for more.

She saw them, in front of the see-through backdoor, pawing to get inside.

Catra opened it and stood in front of Melog with her arms crossed.

'Listen, you're not welcome here anymore.'

'Meow?'

'I just don't want you here.'

The dumb kitten laid down on their back, paws close to themselves. They looked at Catra, waiting for something.

Catra rolled her eyes. 'Just this once, but *only* because I won't ever see you again.' She stepped into her backyard, sandals over

socked-feet.

It was kind of chilly out here… would Melog survive the winter?

She rubbed their belly and Melog began to purr loud.

And they were only a kitten.

They couldn't handle the real world, right?

And Adora was fond of them…

Melog stood up again on all fours and rubbed with their cheek all along Catra's hand.

She sighed, already regretting her next life-decision. 'Fine. Hop in.' She pointed with her head, nodding to the door. Melog seemed to understand her. The moment they heard her, they slipped inside.

What has she just done?

***

Adora wasn't worrying when she came home and found out that Catra wasn't there.

She was probably doing some grocery shopping or was meeting her friends.

Adora did start worrying when she came out of her shower and saw Catra with a big bump outlining her jacket.

Catra… wasn't pregnant, right?

That theory got quickly discarded when she heard a meow come out of Catra's jacket.

'You good, Cat?'

'Yeah… I wanted to try something new. Look if I can rebrand my image.' Catra cleared her throat and a meow came out, followed

by a much softer meow.

The last one done without moving her mouth.

Adora and Catra held intent eye contact for a moment, but something inside Catra's jacket began to stirr.

Out there came Melog.

'I knew it!' Adora moved to pick up the kitten, who nestled comfortably in her arms. She pampered Melog by saying sweet nothings in their ear.

She looked at Catra again and raised one eyebrow.

'Fine, I changed my mind! They were out there-' she pointed at the backdoor '-and they had the audacity to act all cute! I couldn't let them stay there all alone and before I knew it, I was at the vet!'

And Catra had the audacity to act all cute now, starting to look sad.

She sagged a little and muttered, 'I can't believe I got played by a cat.'

Adora walked up to her girlfriend gave her a kiss on her cheek. 'Everyone gets played by cats. That's how cats work.'

She put Melog down, who nuzzled both Catra and Adora at their legs.

Adora pulled her girlfriend in a hug, her head on Catra's. 'We get to be cat moms now.' For good measure, she pressed a kiss on Catra's head.

'I guess so.' Catra pulled Adora closer together.

Chapter End Notes

there's nothing greater than the love of a pet and the parent who said they didn't want them

Finn’s here and it’s cool

Chapter Notes

Early update again! Just wrote this before going to school!

Prompt: “Do we have a deal?”

***

‘I’m bored!’ Finn’s voice rang out from their place at the dinner table, swaddled in a blanket. Their pyjama with little fishes on it was obscured. They sniffled a bit.

Catra was making some chicken soup. She told Finn to stay in bed, but they got bored of that too. She turned the stove off and served them a bowl.

To make sure that it wasn’t too hot, Catra blew on each spoon before giving it to Finn. ‘I know sweety.’

She was glad that she could be there for Finn. Having your five year old child alone and sick isn’t ideal.

They only seemed to have a cold, but it was enough to worry both of their moms. Adora also wanted to stay, but her boss was less lenient about such type of things.

The only reason why Adora did go was because Catra *pinky promised* to send her updates every half an hour.

‘We could watch some cartoons after?’

Finn’s bleared eyes lightened up, ever so slightly.

‘Okay!’

***

Finn was sitting upside down on the couch, a habit they stole from Adora. The Backyardigans played on the tv. It was all background noise to Catra anyway, as she texted her wife an update text.

They sighed dramatically. ‘I’m bored again.’

Yeah, that checks out. Little Finn was always jumping and bouncing around. And today they were restricted to be wrapped up in a blanket for the whole day. Because of their cold they also had less energy, so that’s that.

They sat up again and leaned backwards to let the couch eat them whole. Maybe it was to try if a new sitting position would cure them from their boredom.

Judging the look on their face, it didn’t work.

‘You could draw something?’

Their tiny head shook no.

‘Sleep?’

Another no again.

Catra had one last idea. ‘We could build a pillow fort?’

Finn perked up. Catra held one finger in their face. ‘But, you have to take a nap afterwards-‘ they nodded, ‘-*and* tell Adora that it was your idea.’

Adora wouldn’t stop teasing Catra for being such a softie. That’s not something bad. In fact, it’s something that Catra would do to her too. Only because Catra suggested this out of the love for her child (and therefore out of the *goodness* of her own heart) she decided that she can take a break.

‘Do we have a deal?’

Finn nodded again and they went to building.

***

Adora stormed home. She hadn't had a text from her wife in 32 minutes, so something must be *terribly* wrong.

She wanted to go at 31 minutes, but Catra had made her pinky promise to not jump and run when she didn't get a text one minute late.

The rational part of her brain naturally decided that it *was* okay if there the text was two minutes late. After all, by the time she'd packed her stuff it was already three minutes late, and no text.

She couldn't wait and tempt faith like this.

Adora hopped out of her cubicle and said goodbye to all her coworkers and her boss. She'd get shit for this later, probably, but she didn't care.

***

Adora walked inside of their home, looking left and right. She may or may not have broken a couple of traffic rules, but there was nobody on the road and she was the only one in her car.

In fighting stance, fist out and ready, she walked towards the living room.

Instead of meeting a serial killer, she saw one of the cutest things ever.

Pillows and blankets were scattered everywhere. It did have some resemblance of some kind of… fort?

She walked closer and saw her wife napping with Finn in her arms, tugged tight under her head. Adora's heart grew about ten times more. *Thank God that I listened to Glimmer*, she thought, for the first time ever. If it wasn't for Glimmer pushing them to get a crap load if pillows as 'home deco', she probably wouldn't have seen this.

All Adora wanted was to join them. She laid down behind her wife. She draped her arm over Catra and Finn. Catra stirred a little and looked behind her. She whispered to not wake Finn. 'Hey, princess.' Adora kissed her on the lips and cuddled closer.

'I was worried.'

Now Catra initiated the kiss. 'Sorry, I fell asleep.'

'That's ok-'

'Mom!' Finn wiggled out of Catra's grip and let them go. They body slammed into Adora, who caught them. She was holding them in the air like a little airplane. And Finn? They loved it.

'Hey little one.'

'We built a pillow fort! It was ma's idea!' they pointed at Catra.

The little traitor.

Adora chuckled. She side eyed her wife.

Yeah, Adora's going to give her some good old fashioned teasing for that one.

'That's so cool Finn!'

They nodded and let out a little yawn.

'Wanna nap again?'

They shook their head.

Adora jutted out her lower lip and pretended to be sad. 'Not even with me?'

Another yawn came that they didn't try to stifle. They crossed their arms and tried to frown. Adora started trembling her lower lip and they had to laugh at that.

‘Okay, fine! But only because I don’t want you to *cry*.’

Adora let them down and turned towards Catra. Finn was sandwiched in between them and looked content, closing their eyes.

The blanket had moved, so she pulled it over them all.

Catra looked at her wife. ‘I missed you.’

‘I was gone for not even an hour.’ She leaned in to kiss Catra. ‘But I missed you too.’

Catra pecked Adora on her nose.

Finn wriggled and twitched until they were laying on their back again. They moved their arms in the air. ‘Stop being gross and let’s naaaaaap?’

Their parents chuckled at Finn’s antics.

A nap sounded like a great idea.

It’s a kind of magic

Chapter Notes

CW: Implied character death, feeling like an outcast

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Prompt: “There’s only us.”

***

Different day, same things.

That was how Adora felt while walking through school.

Maybe it was a bit early to think about school like that. She still had a long way to go, from the high school she was in right now.

Life would be more exciting if she had more stuff to do. One of the thing she really wanted to do… was not optional. Not in this stage in her life.

Her fingers trailed over the golden bracelet that covered most of her left arm.

Maybe never. She didn’t know what she was doing, anyway. Just the perks of feeling alone.

And… well, being alone. Life would also be more exciting if she had friends, maybe.

People thought she was different. She knew why, she never really talked much after her mother-

It was one of the reasons why people weren’t mean to her, or anything. That, and usually Adora tried to keep out of other’s hairs.

If she really reflected, she didn't have friends. Not really, though. She did find some people that she hangs out with.

They were decent enough.

They'd… They'd tolerate her, but didn't accept her fully. The fine line became extra clear when they needed to partner up and she was chosen last. Not going to parties or talking all that much had such effects on you in the social hierarchy.

There was *one* thing where she wasn't chosen last in, however. With sports, but she knew why that was the case. She didn't mind, all that much. It made her feel useful, since being school smart wasn't really her thing.

No need to be sad on a fine day like this, though! The start of a new school year is an amazing opportunity to change that.

Yeah.

Adora began to walk straighter.

Everything was going to be better, this year.

It had to be.

***

One of the things that was different met her when she sat down in her first lesson, all the way in the back. Her bag was on the table next to her, so that it looked like it was her choice to sit alone.

Most teachers would say something about it, but not to Adora.

She also didn't really talk much, especially to adults. It was weird to talk to them. They were old and had expectations and opinions of her, even when they shouldn't.

That also made that they thought that she was weird. Adora didn’t mind, though.

When the lesson started, a new someone walked in. Her posture was to immaculate and it contributed greatly in the feeling that she owned the place. Adora had never seen somebody with such confidence walk around. Maybe it was something you got when you were exceptionally pretty, because that was the second thing Adora’s mind focused on when she saw her face.

Adora felt herself light up and the bracelet around her arm became tighter, hotter. There was… something with her. She wasn’t sure what.

She’ll figure out eventually. Or not. Who knows?

Anyhow, the teacher was not amused and began talking from her place behind the desk. ‘Hello class,’ the tone could make anyone fall asleep, ‘-today we have a new student.’

‘’Sup. I’m Catra.’ She looked around the class, analysing everyone. Her eyes locked in on Adora’s.

Oh.

That was strange.

She got noticed.

‘You can sit wherever and then we can start with the reading for today.’

The whole class groaned a bit at that, except Catra and Adora.

Adora who was still in shock.

That was the same Adora who was even more shocked when Catra walked over to her. No hesitation, no nothing.

She sat down and removed Adora’s bag from her desk.

Adora was feeling weird inside and it wasn't from being noticed for the first time. Catra stared at her and her eyes got caught in the light and *she had two different coloured eyes.* All of the alarm bells in Adora's head began to ring louder than ever.

No real person could be this pretty.

Feeling confused and lost, Adora decided to say something. Something brave.

'I'm Adora.' She whispered while the teacher was talking, back towards the class.

'Hey Adora.'

She wanted to know so many things. First of all what Catra was doing here. Next to her. In this school. This town, even.

Second of all, *why did Catra made her feel like*… She didn't even know like what.

Catra moved her focus onto the lesson. Adora decided to do that too.

Her mind zoned out again, not focusing on much off anything, really.

She felt a presence near her thigh. Not her upper thigh, but certainly not her lower thigh either. Then, the slightest flicker of… something? Catra's hand? Touched her leg.

It kind of tickled.

And then it was gone.

Every cell in er body began to work harder. She glanced out of the sides of her eyes, and…

Catra's hands were on the table?

What in the world had touched her just yet?

She moved fast to look under the table, her chair making a screeching sound when she moved backwards.

There it was.

Hovering near her thigh was a tail. In a blink of an eye it was gone again.

Did she imagine it all?

There was no way, right?

She looked around and saw almost everybody look at her.

Damn. Why did chairs need to be so loud?

The teacher decided that she couldn't let it slip, Adora being such a distraction in her lesson. Not that anybody paid attention anyway. Oh well, the teacher also needed to maintain some semblance of reputation. 'Is there anything wrong, Grayskull?'

'Yeah, Adora. Is there anything wrong?' Catra chimed.

'No… not at all.'

The teacher continued writing on the whiteboard. With great intent, Catra looked at it as if dissecting Shakespeare was the most interesting thing *ever.*

Still, the corner of her mouth was upturned in a mischievous grin that didn't fade, no matter how much Adora looked at it.

***

After the lesson, Adora was going to interrogate Catra.

She had to. She was curious and that meant she needed *answers* to keep herself satiated.

Only the girl was fast. She didn’t run, no. She didn’t needed to.

One ring of the bell and Catra was out of the door before anybody had packed their bags. Adora tried to get through the door, but people were blocking it.

When she finally came through it, she saw Catra in the distance. Her back was turned towards Adora, but her face wasn’t. She was looking over her shoulder and smirked again when her eyes locked with Adora’s.

Was she waiting for her? That couldn’t be right.

Catra walked again and Adora was faced by a choice.

Or she’d let her go and enjoy her break in peaceful silence, spending it with people she didn’t like nor dislike.

Or, she’d chase Catra and find out what her deal was.

She choice the latter.

Sorry, but the chance that Catra could get a tail, or *has* a tail was worth exploring.

Catra was fast, but she made sure that Adora could follow her. Soon, they were out of the school, somewhere outside. They were further back than the sport fields, somewhere next to the tiny forest on the school grounds.

A part of Adora feared that this was a trap. Hell, every aspect of it felt like a trap.

Nonetheless, she was ready, walking around in the trees with one hand on her golden bracelet.

She wasn’t ready to see Catra climb a tree *effortlessly*. One would even say graceful.

Was she really going to climb a tree for a mysterious pretty girl? Adora wouldn't be anyone, if not determined, so that answered her question quickly.

Branch for branch she made her way in the tree.

There!

Catra was sitting on a branch big enough for five. Them being only with two, it would suffice more than needed.

That last climb towards the final branch was a bit of a stretch, so Catra held her hand out. Adora took it and was pulled up.

They were pretty high up in the air and they could see all the property owned by their high school and more.

'Took you long enough.'

'If you didn't keep running away, I would be here faster.'

Catra only grinned. 'Okay, but show me.'

'Show you?'

What was this girl talking about?

She nodded towards her bracelet. 'You can show me. There's only us up here.'

'What? No.' She prodded Catra in her shoulder. '*You* can tell me what that tail thing was! What was that?'

Catra tutted in a disapproving tone. 'No way, princess. Show me first.' She nodded towards her bracelet again.

How bad would it be to throw her out of this tree?

Morals, Adora. *Never forget you have morals.* The voice that sounded a lot like her mother Mara sounded in her head.

It seemed like Catra knew what Adora's deal was, already. How she found out, was a mystery to her.

She weighed the choices in her head. Worst case scenario, if Catra tattled on what she'd seen, Adora could deny it.

If people did believe it, well… You can't lose any friends if you don't have any.

'Fine.' Adora grabbed her bracelet and closed her eyes, focusing on what she'd learned. If she did it just right…

'*Whoa*.' Catra breathed out.

Adora opened her eyes again and saw that her bracelet had morphed into a tiny golden cube.

'I knew it!'

Adora rolled her eyes. When was she going to educate her, then, of everything that seemed to go over Adora's head.

Before Adora could ask about it, Catra seemed to change.

Her smooth skin turned… into fur? Her ears became pointy, just like her teeth. And there! Swaying back and forth again, was the same thing she saw in class; a tail.

'Ta-da.'

Catra was a cat.

Adora needed to laugh a bit. 'You really put the cat in Catra.' Catra shoved her a bit, not too hard to not shove her out of the tree.

'Woah. How original. I surely haven't heard that one before.' She rolled her eyes.

The gears turned into Adora's head. 'Wait… how many people know that you're a cat?'

‘Too many. That’s why I switched schools.’

Oh.

Adora was on the verge on apologising profusely, but Catra stopped her. A smile started in the corner of her mouth. ‘But now I have a magic buddy.’

A buddy, huh.

Adora can’t remember the last time she’s been described as a buddy. It did sound kind of nice. Still, something wasn’t adding up.

‘How did you know?’

Catra let out a huff. ‘What, that you’re magic? That’s where I’ve got this one for.’ She pointed at her right eye, the blue one. ‘You were *glowing* so much, it was ridiculous.’

‘Glowing?’

‘Don’t tell me that I need to *teach* you everything. Do you seriously not know anything about theriantrophy, magical realism and *super powers*?’

School’s didn’t really educate people about those things. Better to keep things quiet, they said, so people wouldn’t get reckless and go vigilante. A bogus reason, Adora thought, because it was.

Still, that last option Catra gave stung. Adora fiddled with the cube in her hand, twisting and turning until there was an engraved M in front of it.

She heard Catra gasp besides her.

Adora glanced over at Catra before turning to look away completely.

She couldn’t handle the pitying look.

And of course Catra knew what had happened to her mom.

Everybody did. It was in the news, after all.

The spare times she did hear about magic and stuff in school it was about her mom.

Used as a bad example.

'Don't worry, I can teach you all about it, if you want. My neighbour is an old, *old*, lady and she taught me! Madame Razz is great and you'll love her.'

Adora calmed her breath to reduce the stinging in the back of her eyes.

A lot of things had happened in the past hour. Adora found someone who could teach her more about herself and therefore, her mom. She wasn't alone…? She wasn't alone.

Good thing to know that she wasn't a defect in the universe by merely existing.

And there was another part too good to be true in Adora's mind. From all the things that happened, it was the one that made the least sense to her. 'So… we're buddy's?'

'Duh. I haven't seen anyone like this in your school! How could you not be *bored.*'

Adora decided to not answer that question. It wasn't something that she felt like she should answer, because she was. She was damned bored out of her mind.

'…you wanna become superheroes?' She wanted to follow her mother's steps, but she didn't want to do it alone.

Catra looked at her and Adora felt as if she could look through all the walls that she had build so carefully. 'Of course. We could call ourself Catradora, a team of two.'

‘Why isn’t my name first?’

‘Are you kidding me? How would that even work?’

‘Adoratra? Adorcatra?’ Adora had to laugh at the unholy mixes of their names. Catra flicked her tail to boop Adora’s nose.

Yeah, that did enough to lighten her spirits.

She held out one outstretched hand. ‘What do you say, team Catradora?’

Adora looked down at the hand. (Catra had *claws*?!) She shook it. ‘Nothing really bad can happen, as long as we have each other.’

Catra’s face lightened up the whole way and Adora felt herself mirror that expression.

There’s one thing she was sure about and that was that this year, was going to be different for the better.

(In college they also meet Bow and Glimmer, a skilled archer and a teleporter. Together they become the *Best Friends Squad.* It isn’t always easy, but together they stand strong.)

Chapter End Notes

> i don't know if any of this made sense, but it did when i was writing this

pure chaos

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Prompt: "I never said that."

***

'Oh, by the way, we need to babysit Harmony next Friday.'

Catra said to Adora, chilling on the couch. She's nodding to some non-existent beat, distracted by the phone in her hand.

'Wait a second-' her face scrunched up, 'I thought we agreed to babysit the Flash and Dash.'

'What, no?' Her wife said. There's no way that they've agreed to be responsible for Bow and Glimmer's trouble twins ever again.

'Yeah, I thought we did. Bow and Glimmer were begging that one brunch, remember.'

The realisation hit Catra like a brick coated in wasps. '*Fuck.*' The last time they were with the twins, it didn't end well for all parties evolved. That included Catra, Adora, the twins, a goat and a balloon. 'Could you tell me again why we ever agreed on that?'

'Because they really wanted to visit their parents again and nobody else was available.'

Catra groaned. 'Maybe Harmony will bring peace?' Any child of Perfuma should be just as woozy as she was, right? Add Scorpia as the second mom and nothing will go wrong.

The only real problem with Harmony were their moms. Scorpia and Perfuma are great moms, don't worry about that. The thing was... they had high standards for Catra and Adora.

Last time they babysat Harmony, they earned an hour and thirty-two minute preach about how the energy flow in their apartment was negatively influencing Harmony's natural vibes.

And that was about energy flow alone.

All in all, with Flash, Dash and Harmony, Catra and Adora were in for a rough day.

***

Adora and Catra had cleaned the apartment thoroughly and checked for any potentially dangerous objects for children *thrice,* when there was a knock on the door.

'I'll get it!' Adora shouted from their bedroom, where she was taping down the potential sharp corners of their nightstand.

Catra was way closer and opened the door, to be met by, 'Mermista? Sea Hawk?'

Adora caught up to her and was looking over Catra's shoulder.

'Hey, we're here to drop off Pearl.' How didn't they notice the one year old baby she was carrying?

'Sorry, but we really don't have the time.'

'But Adora promised this months ago,' Sea Hawk started in his overtly dramatic way, 'so that we can enjoy our anniversary.'

'What? I never said that.'

From out of her back pocket, Mermista grabbed a tape recorder that looked awfully much as one Entrapta would use. 'Uh, you totally did.' One hand pressed the play button, while Pearl tried to grab the recorder.

Out of the device, first Mermista's voice came through. *Yo, Adora. Would you be cool and babysit Pearl on Hawk's and I's*

anniversary?'

Adora's voice, clear as day, followed. *'Yeah, of course! When was it, again?'*

'*Twentyfirst of October. You promise this would be aight?'*

'I promise! Pearl is such a sweetheart.'

With that, the recording stops.

Catra glares a bit at her wife, and Adora folds in of herself.

Why is she always such a people pleaser?

'Well, that was months ago.' Catra tries as a last resort. 'We forgot and our apartment isn't ready for Pearl.'

Mermista looks not amused. Sure, it was her standard face, but it still had impact. 'You're apartment is cleaner than ever and Adora is wearing the headband she always wears when she cleans.'

Catra gives her another look.

'It helps me clean better.' She mutters, so that only Catra can hear it.

Mermista hands Pearl of and Catra takes her in her arms and Sea Hawk drops the bag with baby stuff in front of their door. 'Damn me for introducing you to Entrapta.'

Sea Hawk gasps and covers Pearls ears. 'Not cool, Catra. Not cool.'

'Anyway, you know the deal.' Mermista started. 'Call if anything bad happens, even though the biggest hazard is going with me tonight.' She nods at Sea Hawk.

'Have a nice anniversary!' Adora says and it's all it took for Mermista and Sea Hawk to walk away.

***

Adora's bouncing Pearl on her hip, trying to keep her entertained, when there's another knock on their door. Catra opens it and Perfuma, Scorpia and Harmony walk in.

'Hey Adora!' Scorpia's cheery voice rings out, her hands on her child's shoulders.

'Hey!'

Perfuma already grabs her incense and lights it up. The smell of chamomile starts to fill the room and Adora tries not to cough at the smell.

Pearl's eyes become focused on where Perfuma waves the incense sticks around. The light shines in her eyes as she giggles and claps.

'Thank you so much for taking care of Harmony again.'

'No problem, Scorps.' Catra said.

When Perfuma deemed the room clear of negative vibes, she shoved some furniture to the sides to let the life chakras flow more freely through the room. Then, Perfuma inspected Pearl, vibe checking the hell out of that baby.

They had some serious eye contact, Perfuma had one eye narrowed. Scorpia began to stand behind her, always supportive of her wife.

Apparently it was good enough for them. 'Pearl's an okay influence for our sweet little sunflower.'

Harmony rolled their eyes. 'I'm *twelve,* mom.' But like a good mother, Perfuma ignored that sentiment.

'As long as those evil twins-' Perfuma's eye twitched, '- aren't here, everything should be fine.'

‘Don’t forget, Harmony, your mothers love you!’

A round of hugging later, they were out the door.

***

A little bit later on that particular Friday, the door knocked again. Catra was glad to get out of some uncomfortable small talk with a twelve year old.

(Teenagers were scary, okay? Not that she’d ever admit that out loud.)

The only thing that made her regret walking to the door, was because she knew what horrors would wait for her.

She braced herself, opened the door and was eye to eye with Glimmer and Bow. Both of them looked like they had been stuck in a tornado for about an hour.

Catra lowered her gaze and there were the horrors.

‘Hi.’ Bow said. ‘If there’s anything wrong, you have our numbers, okay bye!’

Bow and Glimmer shoved their kids inside and when Catra saw them walk away, she saw a piece of packing foam glued to Glimmer’s hair. Catra shuddered at the thought.

She also shuddered at the fact that the twins were already invading her home.

‘Whoa, it smells like weed here!’

‘Holy shit, do y’all smoke?’

Harmony spoke. ‘That’s just incense. But I can get you the real deal.’ They flipped their blond bangs to the side and a smile started in the corner of their mouth.

Adora who still had Pearl in her arms said, ‘No drugs! No drugs in our house!’

Can you imagine that this was only the beginning of it all?

***

Flash and Dash were too bored out of their minds already. They’ve interrogated everyone in the apartment already, but it wasn’t entertaining enough for those wild souls.

Naturally, they’d decided that a screaming match would suffice.

It didn’t.

‘Hey, you know what would be fun! Playing the quiet game.’ They were together for about ten minutes and Adora was pulling out her big guns.

‘We’re seven!’

‘That trick won’t work anymore!’

Adora groaned. Bow and Glimmer were perfectly good parents, only the age of seven to nine seemed to be problematic in the Archer bloodline. At least, according to Lance and George.

Imagine two more years of this.

She heard the tell-tale sound of the cutlery drawer being pulled open. Adora knew that sounds out of thousands, because duh. Food.

Her head turned in the direction of the kitchen as fast as possible and she saw Harmony throwing-

A knife?!

‘Harmony, no!’

‘I wanted to practice my knife tricks.’

Catra was rocking Pearl in her arms. ‘Flash! Don’t feed your brother paper.’

‘I’m Dash.’

‘The sentiment still stands.’

‘No, it’s okay.’ Flash said. ‘It’s for science!’

‘Please don’t.’ Catra said.

The twins looked sad for a few seconds, but they looked at each other and the mischievous glint in their eyes came back.

Then, they were gone and Catra could breathe again.

Not for long, as Pearl needed to have a diaper change. ‘How could one tiny baby be so *stinky?*’

She went to the bathroom to change her.

Adora had given Harmony a quick lecture about not playing with knifes. Harmony had argued that it was good for them to experiment and be free.

‘You can do that in your parents’ house, but this is not the place for that.’

‘If that’s so,’ Harmony said, ‘then what are the trouble twins doing?’

Adora’s eyes widened and she rushed over to the living room.

Flash had found a whisk and Dash a had a spatula. Adora knew exactly where this was going, as Catra walked in with Pearl again.

Flash struck a pose, the whisk in hand as a sword. His brother Dash was armed with a spatula and they began circling the living room.

Dash used his spatula to swordfight. Clinking could be heard all over the apartment.

The spatula got stuck in the whisk and Flash straightened his arm. In slow motion, Catra and Adora saw the spatula make three flips and knock over a vase.

They were both in shock and began to shuffle themselves. ‘It wasn’t me.’ One said.

‘Me neither.’ The other one exclaimed.

If Catra and Adora were their parents, they could find out who was who.

In this moment though, it didn’t matter.

Adora moved fast to clean the mess and little baby Pearl was crying. Catra was petting her baby hairs and cooed them. Saying sweet nothings didn’t work.

Harmony looked at the baby as if they needed to puke.

Not a fan of baby’s apparently.

They closed their head off and began making their own noise to distract from the piercing cries that Pearl was making.

Even the twins fell silent, hands over their ears.

Adora had cleaned the mess in their living room. She thought of something, anything to help Pearl and then she remembered.

She went to the kitchen and opened one of the upper cabinets.

There! A lighter.

Catra and her had put it all the way up there to make their home kid-proof, but it seemed like this was their last resort.

Adora grabbed it and ran as fast as she could to the baby. She tried to flick it on, but she was never good at that.

Harmony spotted her and grabbed the lighter out of her hands. They did it on the first try, a little flame flickering out of it.

Pearl's cries seemed to slow down until they stopped completely. She was mesmerised by the lights.

Flash had opened his eyes and removed his hands from his ears. He tapped Dash on his shoulder and he also opened his eyes.

They also seemed to be mesmerised by the little flame.

Huh.

Parenting could be kind of easy.

***

'Bye Glimmer, bye Bow. Your kids were wonderful like always.' Catra said, smiling.

And Catra and Adora closed the door.

They'd survive.

Holy shit.

It did get easier when they knew what they needed to do.

Catra had grabbed a candle out of the closet and lighted it up. They all stared at the candle on the dining table for a good portion of an hour.

When they got bored of it, Adora stood at the ready. She had ordered some food that would keep them sweet for a while, and followed it up by carrying them around like little sacks if potatoes.

Kids really seemed to love that, for some reason.

Afterwards they turned on the tv and let them get drowsy. Not all of them fell asleep (only Pearl did, to be exact) but it was enough distraction for their little minds to calm down.

Adora and Catra crashed down on their couch, hugging each other. The rest of babysitting went okay, but the first hour was draining enough for a couple of lifetimes.

'Let's agree to never babysit again.'

Adora hummed. She kissed her wife on the forehead, too exhausted to do anything else. 'It… it was kind of fun.' Her eyes couldn't meet Catra's.

'Yeah. It would be crazy to be around one of those twenty four seven, though.'

'*Totally* crazy.'

They didn't mention how the apartment that was so full of life felt a tad bit emptier without those four kids.

***

Five years later.

'Thank you again Mermista for taking care of our little Finn.' Adora said, ruffling their wild blond hairs.

They made a face but didn't comment on that.

'Totally not a problem.' She said, rolling her eyes. 'It's nice for Pearl to have hang out with somebody her age.'

(Catra and Adora had used the same strategy as Mermista had, all those years ago.

Who knew a voice recorder would come in handy?)

The door closed and Catra and Adora walked hand in hand on their way to the restaurant to celebrate their anniversary.

All in all, it was a good day.

Chapter End Notes

the title is called 'pure chaos', and it also applies on my writing on this one
i struggled a lot with coming up with a good idea on this one, and i kind of wanted to write this and be done with it, so i haven't reread it at all

tattoo of us

Prompt:" Who said this is a good idea?"

***

Adora was laying on something quite similar to a massage chair. She was perked up by her elbows so she could take in the secluded part of the tattoo shop before she was destined to look at the ground for who knows how long.

Her shorts were on her ankle leaving her underwear exposed. She made sure to choose them with care so that Catra could have free access to her right butt cheek, where she was putting on some disinfectant.

She winced. 'That's cold.'

Catra hummed and put the stencil on. 'Of course it is.' She grabbed the stencil and positioned it left and right. Then, deliberately she put it on. 'What do you think?' Catra said, grabbing a mirror.

In the reflection she could see it.

God, what was she doing?

'Just hit it.'

The only thing reassuring her was that she could tattoo Catra right back.

'Yeah? You're sure that this is a good idea?'

'Catra, who said this is a good idea? Nobody. We've talked about this. Just do it, already.'

'Fine! Fine.' She said. 'Your funeral.'

Adora looked at girlfriend and smiled. ‘A worthy death.’ It was after all, Catra’s first tattoo on real skin and Adora was the lucky one who could wear it.

‘One kiss for good luck?’ Her arm stretched out for Catra, who walked closer to her. They shared a tender kiss, with Catra cupping her face.

‘If you don’t want this, you can back out now.’

‘I want this, Cat. And I’ve wanted this for a while now, okay?’ She kissed her again to reassure her. Her girlfriend wasn’t one to admit she was nervous, but Adora could read her better than a book at this point.

‘Do know that this is gonna hurt because you have such a tight ass, though. If it’s too much, tell me.’

‘I’m a big girl, it should be fine.’

Catra looked intently at Adora.

She didn’t look like she was going to move unless Adora said the magic words.

‘I’ll tell you when it’s getting too much.’ Yeah, Adora didn’t have the best track record with telling her limits.

She was working on it, though.

And Catra recognised that and walked to prep some more stuff. The moment of truth getting closer, Adora laid down again.

There were worse chairs to lay on, Adora figured.

A buzzing sound came to life from the whirring tattoo machine. She heard Catra breath in and out, probably calming herself for a last time.

It didn’t take too long before she felt a pinch on her skin. Adora hissed.

‘Oh shit.’ Her girlfriend muttered. ‘You okay?’

‘Yeah, I’m fine.’

Silence.

‘Really! I was just surprised from the feeling, but I’m okay!’

Through her nerves, Catra tried to be her usual suave self. ‘Guess you need to skip leg day once in a while.’

Adora huffed. ‘As if you wanted to miss a piece of this.’ She moved her head out of the headrest and nodded towards her butt.

She saw Catra’s smile. Then she got pushed to lay down again while Catra resumed her tattooing.

Radio music played in the shop, obscured by the soft bussing of the ink machine.

It calmed her. Months of apprenticeship with Catra here and the shop began to feel a bit like a second home.

That was great.

Adora herself needed to be as comfortable as she could.

Not too long more now and she would be in the same position as Catra.

***

Time moved faster than she thought.

Part of it was because the tattoo was only line art, but still.

Before she knew it, the stinging feeling was gone and Catra groaned. ‘What’s wrong?’ Adora trusted Catra completely. There’s

no way she's mutilated her butt, right?

'I just realised I need to see this, every time I want to take you from behind.'

'Catra!'

'What? It's true.'

Adora looked backwards and there it was in all its glory. She had years to think about the implications of that butt tattoo, and it only dawned on her now. 'Oh God. Every time I'll swim.'

'Doctor visits.'

'Oh no…'

'I've told you, your funeral.'

'Touché.'

Her girlfriend began wrapping the tattoo. 'You need to take good care of your fresh tattoo by-'

'-keeping it out of the sun and keeping it dry, yada yada yada.' A spiel they've both told many many people a lot of times already, despite never tattooing on real people. Part of apprenticeship was also informing the people. 'My turn!' Adora was genuinely exited about her chance to practice on a real person.

'Sorry princess, I think I'll pass.' Was she for real? They'd made the deal ages ago.

She wouldn't suddenly stab her in the back, right?

But no, Catra's face was dead serious.

Before falling into a grin. 'Ha! You're too easy princess.'

Phew.

It would've been a little bit ruined if she was the only one with a tattoo on her butt.

'What are you waiting for? Lay down.'

***

The ink was ready and Adora's mind was too.

She got this.

***

About an hour later, it was done.

'I can't believe we really did that.' Catra said, looking at the tattoo on her left butt cheek.

Adora shook her head. 'Me neither.' She inspected Catra's tattoo a bit more. 'It *is* pretty goals, though?'

And yeah, Catra agreed.

***

A long time ago.

(*'We're going to be the best tattoo artists ever!' Catra exclaimed, finishing the last bits and pieces of her portrait of Adora.*

Sticking her tongue out in concentration, Adora did the same thing. 'Totally.' She looked at Catra. 'Almost ready.'

Just a line more there, and…

Adora was done.

They counted down from three to one and showed it to each other.

‘That’s so I cool! I want to tattoo that.’ Catra pointed at the portrait Adora had made from Catra’s face. ‘And you can tattoo this.’ This time, she pointed at the portrait she made of Adora.

Adora gasped. ‘We should tattoo each other, That way, everyone knows we’re best friends forever!’)

***

A slightly less longer time ago.

(‘If you lose, you gotta get our tat on your butt.’ Slightly tipsy Catra said.

‘There’s no way I’ll lose.’ A slightly more than tipsy Adora said.

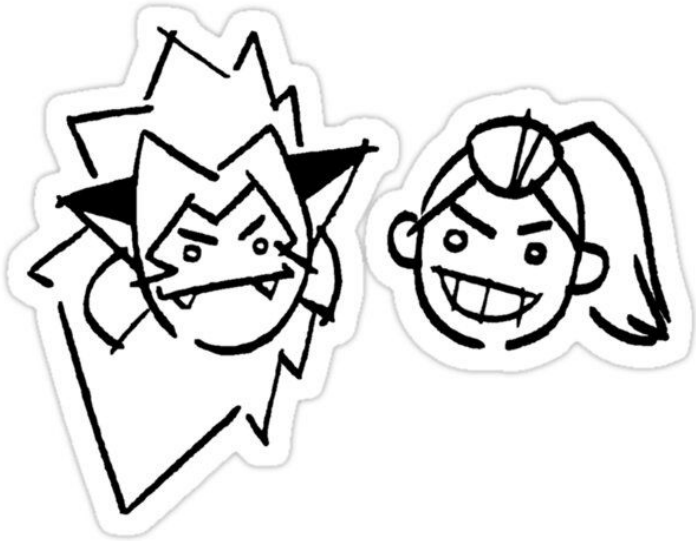
‘Proof it.’

(The only reason why Adora lost arm wrestling that day was because Catra kissed her for the first time.

As some form of consolidation and because she got accused from cheating, Catra decided to get a tattoo there too.

Plus, she was young and thought it would be cool.))

***



Wait... Sea Hawk isn't here?

Chapter Notes

whoops, a late one

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Prompt: "Not on my watch!"

***

Catra took a sip of her coffee. One of the perks of studying in a coffeeshop. That, and the better than average music.

She scribbled a bit in her notebook, trying to calculate the volume of a sphere cut off by a plane.

The third dimension and the converting to spherical coordinates were something to get used to, but nothing too difficult.

Well, if she wasn't so tired to constantly forget the Jacobian.

Her test was only next week, coupled with a handful of others. She had enough time and studying here from dusk to dawn made her feel productive.

The silence and calmness at home didn't stimulate her brain enough, and it was way easier to get distracted. The people that she shared the long table in the coffee shop with, talked enough to have some comfortable white noise. They were kind enough to not scream.

Well, apart from one tinier woman dressed in more hues of pink than Catra had ever seen, but a boy (who wore a crop top? In *October*?) shushed her.

Oh, and one of the other reasons why she wasn't working at home was because her roommate was doing great bits of

something to their router.

Entrapta just had to mess with the Wi-Fi the week before all the exams.

Now Catra was forced to work at the library or a coffee shop.

There was nothing wrong with studying in the library, hell, most of the times she'd prefer it. The only downside was that there wasn't coffee and to be honest, that was the only thing that kept her going.

It kept her focused and awake. She could definitely punch math in the face. She'd punch math in the face *so* dang hard, it wouldn't even know what hit them.

And... She drifted off again. She took another sip of her coffee and got back to work.

***

Adora was severely distracted.

It didn't happen *that* often, but it did happen from time to time. One of those times, was today.

Glimmer and Bow thought that it would be a good plan to study in a coffee shop for their exam week, but no.

There was so much happening here at all times. From customers who said hi to the workers, to the sounds from outside. There were huge windows, so Adora was able to see anything and everything happening.

For example, a man trying to throw away some napkins from the sandwich he'd just eaten. He missed the garbage can about three times in a row. Credit to him, though, he kept trying until his garbage went in, preventing litter.

Sure, it wasn't the *most* exciting thing ever, but it certainly was more exciting than the piece of linguistical philosophy she needed to read.

Philosophy was fun, albeit a bit woozy at times, but this subject didn't hit the mark. The teacher never left room to let the students think and reflect about their own opinions.

How is she supposed to think and form her own opinions if she isn't allowed to? In what world does that make sense?

Speaking about senses, her ability to look wasn't the only thing satiated here.

It smelled like coffee in here.

Good delicious coffee.

That was completely logical and to be expected in a coffeeshop.

But there were cakes too, and the smell of brownies filled the room.

If she closed her eyes, she could almost taste it. She could even smell...

Fire?

Adora opened her eyes again, and saw that a page of the book of the girl next to her had caught on fire. 'Not on my watch!' Adora said, pulling the book away.

The girl looked up, her face a bit paler and shocked, while Adora tried to dim the last embers that danced on the page.

When that was done, she also blew the candle out, just in case.

'Sorry! I couldn't save all of it!' The book was full of weird characters.

Was this girl a witch?

‘Thank you, a lot...?’ she prompted for a name, so Adora gave it to her. ‘Adora.’

‘No problem…?’

‘Catra.’

Catra took the book again and closed it. The front page said calculus. *If that was math, then where were the numbers?*

Adora looked up to finally really look at Catra. And *whoa,* she was pretty.

Sure, her eyes had bags underneath them, but that was the latest mode. Everyone at college was wearing it. Her hair was in a messy ponytail, but one of those kinds that made you wonder if she didn’t spend a lot of time making it look messy.

It looked flawless.

Adora, for a second, felt her own hair poof become inferior in the neighbourhood of Catra’s hair.

But Catra’s whole was just pretty.

Yes, she could write a whole essay about how pretty she is, but she looked exceptionally cute in an oversized hoodie and sweatpants.

Catra had looked at her book for a while, silently thinking.

Maybe about the cost and if she really needed to replace it.

Adora knew all about it. Seeing the price of her books made her consider selling one of her kidneys.

But Catra had looked up at Adora again, giving her a soft, tired smile. ‘Can I treat you a coffee?’

Adora blinked a couple of times. ‘Yeah, of course.’

Chapter End Notes

fun fact: i once saw this happening in a real coffee shop

the person sitting in front of me accidentally dipped the corner of her book in a little atmospheric candle and the person sitting next to her stopped it

ever since, i wanted to write about it, so i'm glad i could!

Fabulash

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Prompt: "Is this safe?"

***

A soft feathery feeling was on her face. It wasn't the worst feeling ever, Adora thought.

It was actually kind of nice, the feel of the soft bristles of the make-up brush on her cheek.

Or maybe the nice part was that Catra was being so gentle with her. Adora has tried to dabble in the world of make-up before, but there was a reason why she didn't do it that often.

If Catra was the one who applied it, she'd sure put on make-up every day.

Catra.

Adora also had the privilege of looking at Catra the whole time she was busy. She looked so concentrated, her eyes focused on whatever part of Adora's face she put the brush on.

Catra has looked at her more often than not, but she didn't think that she's ever been analysed this closely. As if she can dissect every atom of Adora's being by only *looking*.

That was what it felt like to Adora. Her whole insides were rearranged to make room for fluttering butterflies.

The only way Adora could describe it all was as strangely intimate. Sitting on the same bed with Catra leaned closer to her to apply her make-up. Feeling, hearing every breath she took.

Catra put the brush aside and leaned back to take in her piece of art. She tilted her head ever so slightly to the side.

Seemingly satisfied, the corner of Catra's mouth raised. 'Okay, *princess.* Now I'll do your eye make-up.'

If Adora knew one thing, it was that she could never get rid of this nickname again. Why did she wanted to go trick or treating in matching costumes again?

Well, apart from the fact that she could go as one of her favorite book characters.

That, and Catra agreed on being her counterpart ánd doing her make-up.

A win-win situation with only one loss is still winning.

Maybe it was a win-win-win situation. She could tease Catra right back.

'Bring it on, *prince.*'

And she had front row view of Catra, meaning that she could see her eye roll really well. Maybe it was a win-win-win-win situation?

Adora was still thinking about all the pros and cons, while Catra grabbed an absolutely horrifying looking thing.

'What even *is* that?'

'This?' Catra raised the silvery thing, what looked like a scissor, and dangled on one of its loops. 'It's an eyelash curler.'

She moved the thing closer to Adora's face. She automatically leaned backwards on the bed.

Catra pulled the curler back again and chuckled. 'Adora, are you *scared?*'

‘Pffff, I- No. I’m scared of nothing and nobody.’ Catra raised one (perfect) eyebrow. ‘Except spiders. And that was just one time!’

‘So, you would be totally okay with me using this?’

‘Yeah?’ Adora sat straighter to try and convince her body that she meant it. ‘Yeah.’ She said again, this time with more fake-confidence.

The eyelash curler came closer to her eye.

She saw it coming closer and closer and closer, and…

Adora scrunched her eyes closed, with such vigour that she almost saw stars.

‘Chill out, Adora.’ Catra trailed her fingers over Adora’s cheek, gently.

Always so gently.

It coaxed her to open her eyes making Catra’s hand retract. ‘What’s wrong?’

‘It’s just…’ she twiddled with a hangnail on her thumb, trying to figure out how she could word her next thoughts. ‘Is this safe?’

She expected to her a chuckle, maybe an ‘idiot’, but Catra used the eyelash curler on herself with practiced ease. ‘See? Nothing to be worried about.’

Oh.

Well, if Catra could do it, she could do it too.

Mentally she hyped herself up. She let out a breath. ‘Okay. Make me pretty.’

Adora was ready for it! She’s survived a great deal of high school, her mothers cooking and spiders. She could do anothing.

But Catra sat unmoving, biting her lip.

Adora knew that face. Catra made it whenever somebody said something stupid and there were too many people around or when a teacher was nagging about some fickle thing.

It was the face she made when she needed to keep the words from spilling out.

'What?'

'It's nothing.'

'Please say it?' Adora couldn't stand not knowing, so she needed to bring out the big guns. Her puppy eyes. 'For me?'

Catra inhaled and mumbled something.

'Sorry, what did you say?'

'I said,' she started, a bit louder this time, 'I can't make you pretty, because you already are.'

Lately, Catra has been doing that a lot. Giving her such compliments and stuff.

How inconsiderate, given that Adora is already feeling head over heels for her. If Catra kept this up, Adora wasn't sure she could function anymore.

On the positive side of things, this way Adora didn't need any blush.

Catra grabbed the eyelash curler and within five seconds, she curled both of Adora's lashes. 'See, that wasn't so bad, right?' Her usual edge and teasing tone was undermined by the fact that she was looking the other way, still ashamed.

If Adora leaned forward, she could just…

She kissed her. She kissed Catra.

Crap!

She needed to be smooth. Adora could be smooth.

Hell, she was so smooth that she had kissed Catra on the cheek.

Just a few seconds ago, with the silence stretching longer.

Quick, say something!

'Thank you, my prince.'

Well, she's definitely said worse things before. Like heck and snicker*noodle*.

(Yes, that last one was also because of her mom's cooking.)

Catra turned to look at her. The first movement she's made since that kiss. 'Anything for you, princess.'

She sounded so *soft.* Like a new blanket, that hasn't been through the wear and tear of laundry yet. Or the feelings of petals on your skin, when you trace flowers with your hands.

And Catra looked down, to her lips.

It made Adora look down at Catra's lips too.

They were so close, if Adora leaned forward, she could just…

***

Couples costumes were a good idea, Adora thought, as she was trick or treating with her hand holding Catra's. *A great idea, even.*

Chapter End Notes

If you were wondering, the costumes I had in mind for Catra and Adora were Kai and Cinder from the lunar chronicles

Also, I can't believe that there's only a week left of Fictober?!?!?!?

What?

Uno pollo, por favor

Prompt: "You know I'd do anything."

***

'Catra, please, don't do it.'

'You know I have to.'

'If you really love me, you wouldn't.'

'Oh, you can't play that card.'

'Then don't play yours.' Adora said, her body shaking from exertion.

Bow and Glimmer were watching Adora and Catra spill out words from left to right.

Who knew a game of Uno would be so intense?

To be fair, it was their *tenth* round already, Adora had one card left and Catra hinted to have a +4 card.

Oh, and Adora had lost all of their matches.

'Please, Catra. You know I'd do *anything*. Just let me have this.'

A devilish smile played on Catra's lips. 'Anything?'

'Anything, I *promise*.'

'Even that one thing you hate so much?' Catra quirked her eyebrow.

Adora nodded. 'Even that.'

Catra looked at the green card on the table, with a big 3 printed on top. She looked up at Glimmer and Bow, checking if they had

the same thoughts as Catra. Glimmer even went so far to get a glint in her eyes. Less competitive Bow also couldn't hide his glee.

Looking back at Adora, Catra sighed, faking apprehension. 'Fine.' She muttered and grabbed a card from the drawing pile.

With a force that could summon an earthquake or two, Adora put down a red 3. 'Yes! I finally did it! Get wrecked!' She was all but screaming.

The other three looked at each other and at exactly the same time said, 'you forgot to say uno.'

Adora shook her head in disbelieve. 'This can't be happening.'

'Well, it just did!' Glimmer said.

They all could see Adora's happiness whiter down and die, leaving it to crumble on the ground.

If it wasn't for the temporarily battle field they've created, Catra would almost feel bad.

Almost.

Adora looked at Bow, the only one she could trust at a time like this. He gently shook his head. 'I'm sorry 'Dor, it's true.'

She grabbed two cards from the pile.

Glimmer hit a combo, where she could play all of her cards. Being dramatic, she paused when she only had one card left in her hand. She looked at Adora and whispered, 'Uno.'

The card was played.

Adora has lost many times that day, but this one was the cruellest of them all.

She could feel victory not too long ago. She was tasting the a hint of the sweetness it brought as an amazing appetizer.

Now all she tasted was the bitter feeling that sat in her chest.

Catra scooched closer to her, hugging her arm. She kissed Adora's cheek. 'Thanks for the favour.'

Adora drooped her head lower.

***

'You know, I thought that this would be worse.' Adora said, standing in the midst of a crowd of a Halloween party that Scorpia and Perfuma hosted.

'And I thought that this would be better.' Catra said.

The whole night people had been walking towards them and worst of all, *talked* to them. Sure, socialising is great and all, but she wanted a moment alone with her girlfriend.

Adora pulled Catra in by the waist. The arm of Adora's costume was soft and tickled Catra's side.

She really should've rethought their costume ideas. Catra shouldn't have worn a crop top, but she didn't have the motivation to wear something fancier than a low-effort costume.

Of all their friends, going as Bow was the wrong choice, though.

She literally has free access to Adora's closet. Missed opportunities.

Speaking off…

'I should've made you relax instead of wearing *this*.' One of Catra's hands pointed at the full-on chicken costume that Adora was wearing.

A shudder ran through Adora's body, that Catra could feel by their closeness. 'You could've, but you didn't.' Adora said. 'Because you *love* me.'

‘Unfortunately.’ Thát and Adora had suffered enough at game night.

Seriously though, how could somebody be that bad in uno?

Adora leaned in closer and kissed Catra’s cheek, followed by her nose and then one on the lips.

Her smile was radiant and Catra tried to play grumpy for a couple of seconds more, with crossed arms. Adora pecked her once more on the lips for good measure.

At the exact moment Catra felt like that she could let her grumpy façade dissolve, she heard laughter.

‘Careful Catra, you might get *chicken pox*!’ Glimmer said, barely getting the words out.

Bow stood next to her laughing. The only difference was that he was raised with manners and tried to hide it.

Catra couldn’t stand seeing those two so she buried her face in the pit of Adora’s chicken costume.

Maybe that was one of the only right decisions she’s made going to this party. It was soft and fluffy and the fabric was graced by Adora’s scent.

Catra didn’t need to see the world, she exist happily ever after in the nook of Adora’s body.

Adora wrapped her hands around Catra as if to say that she was also perfectly fine with Catra staying there forever.

Glimmer burst out in laughter again, absolutely destroying Catra’s peace. ‘I guess she’s-’ Glimmer tried her best to get some air in her lungs from the cacophony of laughter she’s letting out. ‘-she’s *chickening out*.’

Yup. Catra was never going back to the real world.

She was perfectly fine groaning in agony, muffled by Adora's body.

Adora, the sweetheart, *her* sweetheart, kissed her on the head.

Pixie cut(e) – version 2

Chapter Notes

Ear 👏 ly 👏 up 👏 date 👏

Prompt: "I'm doing it, shut up."

***

'Adora, I trust you. Go ahead.'

'But I don't trust myself with this.'

Adora looked at herself in the reflection of the bathroom mirror. She then lowered her gaze to look at her girlfriend with a poncho on, sitting on the shitty stool they found somewhere down the road.

'Babe, you can do this.'

She squeezed the hair clippers in her hand and laid it on the sink. 'What if I mess this up?'

Catra turned around, still on the stool. She looked up at Adora and grabbed her hands. 'Although I'm fine with an ugly haircut, I'll promise you'll do great.' She lifted their hands and kissed them several times.

Most of Adora's worries lifted. How could she think about anything other than Catra's soft lips on her hands, while she's looking at her with so much *trust* in her eyes?

'I don't want you to have to walk around feeling like a clown.'

'I already do, walking with you.' Catra joked.

A hint of truth was behind it. Yesterday she had a dream about Adora with her walking around in a giant chicken suit.

Weird.

Adora wasn't laughing though, so Catra decided to hit a more serious note. She lowered their hands, not quite stopping the soft circles she was drawing on Adora's knuckles. 'Babe, it's just about doing something different for once.' Adora bit her lip. 'Besides, if it weren't for you, I'd give Glimmer free reign on my hair, and we both know she'd give me a mullet out of spite.'

'You'd pull it off.'

'A mullet?'

'Without a doubt. You could pull everything off because you're so pretty.'

'And therefore I could also wear any haircut you give me.' No amount of effort could pull her laughing muscle down as her face morphed into a smirk. The big sap had shot herself in the foot.

Adora lowered her head so that her and Catra's forehead touched. 'If you regret this, you can't get a refund.'

'I'm aware.'

She kissed Catra's nose and turned her around. She took the hair clippers that were laying on the bathroom sink.

Flicking a switch, it started it's buzzing noise. She could feel it reverberate in her hand.

Her reflection stared at her and she could look at herself. Eyes wide, jaw tense, it was all in line with what she's feeling.

Panic. Internal panic.

Moving from underneath the poncho, Catra's hands appeared to give her two thumbs up in the reflection. Her girlfriend was clearly going through it.

Maybe she could hype her up the way Scorpia always tried to.

Her voice was clearly not made for this, as it fell flat. Still, it was better than nothing, she supposes. 'You can do it.'

Nothing happened. Maybe more? And faster.

'You can do it. You can do it. You can do it, you can do it, youcandoit, *youcan*-'

'I'm doing it, shut up.' The hair clippers made contact with Catra's hair, shutting Catra up. A chunk of her curly, thick hair fell down to the floor. 'Oh my god I'm doing it.'

'Hell yeah!'

***

After cleaning everything up, Catra had showered to get the lose hairs off of her head.

Adora wasn't ready to see her emerge.

Because *hot damn*, her girlfriend was hot.

Rationally, she knew her girlfriend was absurdly hot, but seeing her like this? With a short and spicy pixie cut? That she *cut herself*?

She couldn't believe her luck.

It was different. That was how Adora justified staring at her girlfriend all day, even when she was cooking some dinner. The smell of herbs and spices danced around in their tiny kitchen, but Adora was focused on something else.

'You're staring again.'

Adora hummed. 'You're just-' Catra turned to look at her. '-*whoa.*' Catra chuckled, as if Adora's brain wasn't fried enough.

She walked closer toward her girlfriend. Her arms wrapped around Catra. One hand found their way up to scratch at the back of her head.

Feeling the short hairs on Catra was a completely new sensation. Her curls had been *so* soft, but Adora can now go through the motions of petting Catra over and over again. Her hair didn't tangle anymore. Catra too, seemed to enjoy the feeling of Adora's hands on her. After all, her eyes were closed and she hummed.

Adora could get lost in this moment and she wouldn't mind.

This was what life was all about, wasn't it?

Not about school or work or something, but about being in the here and now with her girlfriend in their tiny kitchen.

It's about the happiness you find together in small moments like this.

It's about-

Oh crap.

Catra's eyes shot open.

'The food.'

She fled Adora's arms and put the pan with burnt ashes in the sink.

That was one bridge burnt.

'Wanna order?'

'Deffo.'

It's about opening the windows to get rid of the burnt smell, cuddling up because of the cold winds that come through and eating take-out boxes with the person you love.

hearts of the party

Chapter Notes

guess what? BARELY made this update in time
i also woke up today and chose (tiny) VIOLENCE, so be aware

CW: light angst(?), misunderstanding, mentions of a shitty adoption process

Prompt: "That's not why we're doing this."

***

Adora looks down at her phone. Catra could be here any moment now…

No? No knocking.

Hmmm… Too bad, Adora thought she was pretty in tune with Catra and could predict around what time she would knock, but apparently that's-

Knocking!

There was knocking on her window, more like a soft thudding noise. She wanted to open the window. Something she's done dozens of times before proved to be quite challenging. The only light source she allowed herself was the light emitted from her phone screen. If her moms found out that she was sneaking out tonight, she'd be dead.

Not just dead, but probably eaten up, only to be spit out again, type of dead.

She finally found the lever to fully open her window.

Nice!

Catra peaked her head inside. ‘You coming, dork?’

‘Yeah, yeah.’ She whispered back. Adora put her head through the window and saw that Catra was standing on her tip toes.

How cute.

Her window wasn’t even that high, considering that this was on the ground level.

Adora went through the window, one leg through the window.

Yes, the other one!

She wobbled a bit on her landing. Catra’s hands came up to Adora’s waist to help her regain her footing, but it only made her feel more unstable.

The hands left her waist, although the feel of them was permanently imprinted on her body. More like branded on her skin, as the ghost of Catra’s hands felt like fire.

Catra held one hand out. ‘Ready?’

‘As much as I’ll ever be.’ She took it.

Hand in hand, they walked to Catra’s car.

She sat down in the passenger seat. One she’s sat in so much, that it was a wonder that her body hadn’t left a dent in the synthetic leather.

It wasn’t the fanciest car ever, just an old beat up thing. One of the kinds you’d look at and wondered how it could still drive. It was more than enough for the two of them.

Catra looked at her in the rear view mirror. She twisted the key and drove, the headlights battling the darkness of an October night.

Silence filled the empty spaces between them. Adora didn't know if she should be happy or sad that the radio hadn't crackled to life.

'Where are we going?'

Catra looked at Adora for a second. She turned her head back fast to look at the road.

There wasn't any oncoming traffic, yet.

'It's a surprise.'

Adora's jaw clenched involuntarily. Looking at Catra made her stomach twist in turn, so she looked out of the window. There wasn't much to see, as the lampposts only illuminated a tiny bit of the road.

The lampposts did look sad, with their heads down.

Adora knew how they felt.

Surprise, hmmm? Adora knew what this was and what it was about.

She only hoped that Catra could tell her about the stupid plan. It was more see-through than glass.

She also hoped that her best friend knew her better than this.

***

As always, the canteen was full of life. Catra and Adora were sitting next to each other, their knees touching when Glimmer walked by to take a seat. 'Guys, you must hear this!' she said, as she slammed her tray full of questionable food on the table. 'This Friday they're gonna have the party of the century!*'*

'No thanks.' Catra said.

'Agreed.'

‘No, but Adora, you really need to go! Everybody does. ’

‘Everybody?’ A glint formed in Catra’s eyes when she asked it.

‘Yes, everybody. *Except you, ‘cause you’re a lost cause.’ Glimmer directed her attention towards Adora again. ‘Don’t you wanna have fun for once? Put all the… stuff… behind you and act like a normal teenager?’*

Catra clenched her fists and opened her mouth to say some things she probably shouldn’t. Just in time, Adora put her hand on Catra’s shoulder, grounding her. All the anger seemed to seep through her body.

‘No, I’m fine.’ Adora said.

She hoped that would be the last she’d hear about it.

***

Adora wasn’t sure what made her change her mind.

Maybe it was Glimmer’s comment.

But what did it matter that she just got adopted? Yeah, sure, it wasn’t the ‘normal’ way the process should’ve gone with a lot more lawyers and courts than needed, but she still was a normal kid!

She thought that Catra understood that.

It sounded like she did in their talks, their heart to heart.

At most times it felt like she could confide Catra in everything. That Adora could open her heart and then be treated as a normal person.

Hell, Catra made her feel special and understood.

But going to this party? So that they weren’t missing out on something they both didn’t want to go to? Just for the… the

semblance! Of having a ‘normal’ youth.

And to cover it up by saying that it’s a *surprise?*

It made the acid inside of Adora boil, the same feeling you got when you ate something funny.

‘Hey, if you’re worried about your parents-‘ Catra started, one hand on Adora’s knee. ‘-I kind of asked them beforehand if they were cool with us sneaking out.’

Adora was so deep in thought, she hadn’t even noticed that she slumped down in the car. ‘You asked my moms?’

‘I mean, yeah? They’re important to you and I want this night to be perfect. Is that... Is that weird?’

‘No.’ A perfect night? How could that be possible like this?

The harsh answer made Catra retract her hand. Adora wasn’t feeling it right now. She turned to look at Catra’s side. Her eyebrows were furrowed and her thumbs drummed on the steering wheel.

‘So... How’s the weather?’ Catra flinched while asking.

Adora wasn’t in the mood for this shit. ‘Catra, I know what’s going to happen.’

‘You do?’

‘Yes. Can we go back?’

Catra pulled the car aside. Despite not having to watch the road anymore, she looked in front of her. She gripped the steering wheel so tight that her knuckles became white. She tried to regain her breath but the air around her felt constricting, suffocating her.

Catra needed to… to say something. It was difficult, chewing through the blockade in her throat, but she managed. Barely.

‘Sure.’

‘Hey Catra. I don’t mean it like that, it’s just- I know we’re going to that stupid party, but I’m really not in the mood for that.’

Her voice broke. ‘Party?’

‘Yeah the one Glimmer boasted?’

‘Adora, that’s not why we’re doing-‘ she waved a hand above the steering wheel ‘-this.’ She turned around to look at her.

She’s never seen Catra this distraught.

Catra opened and closed her mouth. ‘Can I show you?’

Adora took Catra’s right hand, brought it closer to her mouth. Her lips graced Catra’s hand, afraid to add too much pressure as if that would knock Catra out of orbit. ‘Of course.’

She guided Catra’s hand back down and let go. Catra looked at her hand for a couple of seconds.

Adora didn’t want to break their silence. The only thing she could do was watch. So she saw how her best friend slowly awoke from her reverie and was set in motion.

This silence felt different. Adora hoped that the radio would magically come to life.

Only it didn’t.

She couldn’t look at Catra, so she faced the window. Familiar spots of their town moved by as they reached a more woodsy area.

Wait a second… Adora recognised this pathway. It was one of the more ‘exciting’ things to do in their hometown. But why would Catra bring her here of all places? On the tiny hill, somewhere in the forest. The one place where they could see the whole town

and spot their homes when they were lucky enough to get a spot in the made-up parking spots.

They were lucky, at least today, as Catra pulled over.

‘Why are we…?’

‘Here? Because no one else is.’

Cool.

Adora was alone. With Catra. In a car. At a spot where numerous teenagers hang out through out the day with a purpose.

This place was dubbed make out point for a reason. It was the most romantic spot in the whole town, with all the lights from the tiny houses. Whenever you got bored of that, you could always look up. There were even more lights because of the stars that danced in the sky.

It was *the* place where couples became couples.

‘Oh.’ Adora said.

‘Yeah.’ Catra said back.

Catra tried to take shallow breaths. She felt Adora’s gaze bore into her, waiting for her to do *something*.

She couldn’t look back.

The silence was scarier than what was about to happen for Catra, so she did the only thing she could.

She filled it.

‘I’m sorry, ‘Dor.’ She closed her eyes. ‘I don’t want to leave you hanging, but...’ she wiped away a tear.

It hadn’t fallen yet, so it didn’t count as crying.

Right?

Catra has been hurt before. Physically, when she fell out trees. Still, the thrill of doing it was enough to get back. And mentally.

But she didn't want to talk about that.

Still, the most painful thing ever was this.

Rejection.

From Adora.

Fuck.

Now she *was* crying.

She was crying and stuck in a car with the girl that made her.

(It wasn't even Adora's fault, but Catra's.

She was stupid enough to hope and dream, only to remember too late that nightmares were dreams too.)

Adora's hand gently touched the underside of her chin and guided it to make Catra look at her.

Adora was blurry.

'Catra?'

She squeezed her eyes shut, not wanting to see Adora tell her no. Tell her to fuck off somewhere, just as long as it was out of her life.

The memory would haunt her, guaranteed, but that didn't mean she wanted visuals.

Adora's hand cupped her face and caressed it. 'I love you.' She put their foreheads together.

‘What?’ Catra barely croaked out.

‘I love you.’ Catra fluttered her eyes open and saw Adora. Her blue eyes stared at her, breaking into her soul and told her that she meant it. ‘I’m sorry for assuming… well, everything. I’m so, *so* sorry Catra.’

‘You love me?’

‘I do.’

‘Could you say it again?’ She’d heard it *twice*, but she needed it to be there, to be real.

‘I love you. I love you *so much* that it makes my heart hurt.’

Catra laid her hand on Adora’s. ‘I love you too.’ She moved their hands to press a kiss on Adora’s.

Adora pulled her in for a hug. The angle above the gear stick made it awkward, but neither cared.

All they needed was to be there for one another.

They sat there for a while and they sat there even longer when Catra heard Adora sniffing. ‘I love you.’ Catra said, followed by Adora saying that she loved her too, over and over again until it became silent murmurs into the night.

Little by little, Catra pulled back. Adora’s face was red from all the exertion and there were trails of dried up tears on her cheeks. Catra wiped them away.

‘Wanna look at the stars?’

‘Wanna be my girlfriend?’

Believe her, Adora had *tried* to stop herself. Only, seeing Catra so… so shy, so soft. Her looking at her like Adora was the only person that really mattered to her.

It made all her restraints fade away.

‘How about we do both?’

‘I’d love too, just like I love you.’

‘You big sap.’ Catra tried to act natural by playing the teasing role, to pretend that they didn’t have an emotional breakdown just a few seconds ago. Her teasing was undermined by the smile that she wore.

Although, it was more like a big grin.

Their foreheads touched again, a gesture that was just *theirs* and she whispered. ‘I love you too.’

Spoopy! (compared to the rest)

Chapter Notes

HAPPY BIRTHDAY TO CATRA!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!

as an ode to this cat girl and the amazing month of October, here will be the only fic that has *some* spooky elements

Prompt: "We all have our reasons."

***

Catra was waiting in front of a restaurant for her girlfriend. She looked at her watch. Adora should be there any moment now.

Footsteps were loud behind her and Catra tried to keep her gaze on her watch, one hand in her pocket.

The sounds became closer, and...

Catra turned around, a finger pointing at Adora. 'Boo!'

Adora jumped. She may or may not have let out a little scream. 'No!'

'You're getting too predictable, princess.'

Adora pouted. Ever since admitting to the so called 'best friend squad' that she wasn't scared of anything, they all had a weird fascination to try to spook her anyway.

Catra kissed the pout from Adora's face and when she pulled back, Adora was smiling again. 'Shall we?'

'Yes!' Adora's excitement came back. It was weird how Adora seemed to be way more hyped about Catra's birthday than she was, but oh well.

She gave her arm and Adora took it. Together they walked into this fancier than usual Italian place.

***

A candle lit on the table and some background music from a live band set the scene. The smell herbs and spices filled the air as it wafted upwards from their plates.

Adora picked the olives out of her dish and put them on Catra's plate. Catra pricked one with her fork and ate it.

Damn, even these olives were supreme.

'How was your work?' That was the reason why they couldn't travel together. Adora still needed to finish some paperwork or something and then rushed straight to here.

That she, despite all that, still looks so stunning was a mystery to Catra.

Or actually not. Adora could pull off everything, and that made Catra want to pull off all of her clothes.

Restaurant, Catra! She thought. *Put a filter on your damn brain.*

'Good.' Adora said and she looked everywhere but at Catra.

'Yeah? They've been making you work a lot, lately. You should get a raise.'

'Nah, it's fine! Besides, tonight is about *you.'* She grabbed Catra's hand and gave a tender kiss on it, then let it go. 'Let's not talk about boring stuff!'

Adora's been doing that kind of a lot, lately... Every time work came up, she acted weird and deflected real fast.

The thing is, Catra wouldn't be wary of anything, if it weren't for the fact that it's been over *two weeks* since Adora started acting

weird. And Catra knows her better than anything.

It's almost as if Adora was hiding something from her.

But that would be crazy, right?

She trusted Adora with her whole heart and more, but this started to get fishy.

Catra didn't want to spoil the mood, so she let it go. She took a bite from something other fishy and her eyes widened. 'You *have* to taste this.' She grabbed a bit of the aqua pazza with her fork and gave it to Adora.

Her girlfriend ate it and judging by the face she made, she quite enjoyed it too. '*Holy...*'

'You gotta try mine too!' Adora pricked in her pasta with her fork and brought it over to Catra's mouth. Catra tried real hard to not make inappropriate sounds.

This was one good restaurant.

***

After dinner, Catra and Adora were walking hand in hand. Instead of going straight home, Adora asked if they could take a walk.

Catra agreed, cause she could be happy anywhere as long as she was with Adora.

'God, I can't believe I'm this *full*.' It felt like her body could burst from the sheer amount of food that she'd consumed.

The dessert she got from it being her birthday also didn't help.

Adora poked her belly with her free hand. 'It's because you ate all my food.'

Yeah… stealing food from her girlfriend also wasn't the best idea, but still. 'Don't shame the birthday girl.'

‘I’m not!’ Adora said, in mock offense. ‘I *do* hope you’re ready to become a mother. I think my food baby are going to be twins.’

Catra squeezed her hand. ‘With you I think I’m ready for everything.’

Adora looked at her in wonder.

That changed in tense. Tenser than usual, as they reached a more forest like part of the forest.

Did she say something wrong?

Adora started tapping her fingers on Catra’s hands. Something she only did when she was feeling nervous.

‘Catra. I need to get something of my chest.’

She trusted Adora, one hundred percent.

Catra praised herself to never be scared of anything, but the split second she imagined that Adora would break up with her made her afraid.

Adora was too sweet, too nice to do that on her birthday.

So what *was* she going to tell her instead?

They came to a stop and Catra had only eye for Adora.

Adora, who looked away. ‘I joined a cult.’

Huh.

From all the things she’d imagined Adora would say, it certainly wouldn’t be that. Adora was totally shitting with her.

‘What kind of cult?’ she asked, her tone a bit too smug.

‘One that is frowned upon by many, *many* religious instances.’ Adora still didn’t look at her. ‘They want you to join.’

‘Why?’

‘…we all have our reasons? Very good reasons. Yeah. I just…’ Adora scratched the back of her head. ‘…forgot them?’

Catra rolled her eyes. ‘Sure.’

Out from the woods emerged about a dozen people in black cloaks. Their faces hidden by their hoods. The dim moonlight that shone through the trees also didn’t help.

She was encircled by them and Adora let her hand go. She slowly walked back out of the circle that was closing in on Catra.

In low whispers the people were chanting repeatedly. ‘*One of us.*’

They walked closer and closer and Catra spinned in circles to look at all of them. The small glimpse of the mouths she saw from underneath the hood were in small smiles as they kept chanting.

The group was getting close, so close that Catra herself felt closed off.

They stretched their hands out and their chanting became louder and-

And they took Catra.

By surprise, as their arms wrapped around her body. She closed her eyes as she heard an all too familiar laugh.

‘Ha! I knew we could do it!’

Glimmer.

Of fucking course.

The voices of more familiar people came to life after that as they gave her some room. In the background she heard Adora laugh her ass off.

The cloaked figures put down their hoods and she should've guessed it.

It was their friend group.

Even Sea Hawk was there.

Him being him needed to start a song. 'We need to congratulate the birthday girl! *Happy birthday to you~*' he started singing and soon there was an out of tune chorus of people singing the song.

Catra was never this confused in her entire life. Adora wrapped her arms around her from behind and also sang along. She gave her a kiss on the cheek when the song ended and rested her chin on her shoulder.

'Why?' Catra said, looking at her friends.

'Social experiments!' Entrapta said.

Scorpia shrugged her shoulders and Perfuma tried to look innocent.

'Well, remember that convo we had two weeks ago?' Bow started.

'You said, "I'm never afraid. 'Cause I'm Catra and I'm cool, *bleh*".' Glimmer said.

'I do not sound like that!'

Mermista chimed in, twirling her hair. 'Uhhh, except you totally do.'

'I can show you recordings!'

Ignoring Entrapta, Catra turned to Glimmer again to hear the rest of the story.

'And then you were boasting and showing off how you're never scared.'

‘Then you also said that it would be a *gift* to feel scared for the first time ever, so you’d still know that you were human.’

Oh yeah. Now that Bow said that, she did remember herself saying that.

But hey, she was tipsy. Can you blame her?

‘Okay… But how did you pull this off with Scorpia and Adora?’

‘I didn’t know anything until the last moments! My sweet little sunflower helped me with that.’ Scorpia looked at Perfuma. If Catra didn’t know how it felt to love like that, she’d think it was gross.

Catra turned her head to look at Adora. She moved to hold Catra’s shoulders. Adora took a deep breath to let the next words flow without interruption. ‘I’m sorry I felt *so, so* bad these past weeks and I know you knew that something was up but I didn’t want to spoil the fun so I tried really, really hard so I kind of to hid behind my work but I never want to hide anything *ever* again from you. I swear, this will be the last surprise party I’ll ever throw for you and not because I don’t love you, but because I love you too much and I can’t handle-’

Catra kissed Adora, shutting her up effectively. Their friends cheered.

Who knew if it was because of their cuteness or because Adora shut up?

The world will never know.

(It was definitely the latter option.)

‘Okay, this is fun and whatever, but we have a party boat, presents and a reason to get drunk. So, what are we waiting for?’ Mermista said.

‘Great idea, dearest!’

With Mermista and Sea Hawk leading the pathway to their boat, the rest of the friends followed them.

Adora was holding Catra's hands again. 'I've also got a present back home and I think you'll *very* much enjoy it. We can use it immediately when we get back.' she whispered. Adora didn't need to add the wink after using *that* tone of voice, but she sure did.

Adora gave Catra one more kiss on the cheek. 'Happy birthday, Cat.'

She really loved her girlfriend.

(A couple drinks later and Catra would also be gushing about how much she loved her friends and their absurd ideas of fun and how they all should be themselves forever because they're more than amazing already.

Yeah, this was one good birthday.)

Workaholic Catra

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Prompt: "You love this, don't you?"

***

Catra's behind her laptop sitting hunched over a desk.

She's almost done! She made great progress on her research report, and now she only needs to write a bomb ass conclusion and discussion, when her girlfriend walks in.

Adora walks up to Catra and hugs her from behind. She's greeted by a kiss on her cheek.

'Hey Catraaaa~'

'Hey Adoraaaa~'

Adora gives her a kiss on her other cheek. 'You wanna take a break and give your girlfriend some attention?'

Catra's eyes are still laser focused on the screen. She only needs *one* good and reliable source and-

Wait, what did Adora say?

She turned around to look up at Adora. 'Sorry, what?'

'Let me say it in a way you can understand it.' Adora sat down in Catra's lap. 'My hypothesis is that I'm very kissable. Wanna check it?' She says, all grinning.

Catra raises her head up to reach Adora, but Adpora moved backwards. She tried it again, but Adora kept her out of reach. 'What?'

‘What?’ mocked Adora. She looked at Catra’s lips and leaned in.

The smile on Adora’s face was the last thing Catra saw before closing her eyes. Then she felt a kiss on her cheek. ‘Hey!’ Catra was indignant. She was promised a kiss, right?

Adora slowly kissed a path, each kiss closer to her lips, until she kissed the corner of Catra’s mouth.

Nothing came after that.

Except a giggle. (Okay, that was kind of cute.)

Catra opened her eyes.

‘What’s wrong Catra?’ she tried to act nonchalant.

She rolled her eyes. ‘You love this, don’t you?’

‘I don’t know what you’re talking about.’ But the mirth in Adora’s eyes said more than her words. Catra held her gaze until Adora cracked, her laughter filling the room again. ‘Maybe I do. What you’re gonna do about it?’

Her hands came up to stroke up and down Adora’s waist. ‘Kiss me?’

‘Hmmm…’ Adora pretended to think. ‘I’ll consider it if you ask nicely.’

Catra rolled her eyes. Her hands came to a stop and that was all the warning Adora got before Catra poked at her sides.

Adora laughed uncontrollably. Her sides were a weak spot and they both knew it. Catra tried her best to keep her 5 feet 6 girlfriend from falling off her lap. It was fairly difficult, so she stopped poking her.

‘Dearest love of mine, may I have a kiss?’

The laugh in her eyes wasn't gone when she answered. 'You may, my love.' Adora leaned in again and Catra was *finally* getting that promised kiss.

Or so, she thought.

Adora's lips touched her nose. '*If* you come and eat dinner with me.'

'Dinner?'

'It's already eight, Cat.'

'Eight?' Her eyes widened. She hadn't realised that she'd been couped up behind her desk all day.

No wonder Adora was in need for attention. She'd kind of ignored her unintentionally… for a *whole* day. 'Let me pamper you? I'll cook your fave.'

A smug smile came upon Adora's lips again she poked Catra's shoulder. 'You can't, *I* already made *your* fave.'

Small gestured like this made Catra's heart grow bigger, just to have more space for Adora. She really loved this dork and she needed to be reminded of that.

Adora stood up from Catra's lap and Catra stood too, to take her girlfriend in a hug. 'I love you.'

'I love you too.' Adora kissed the top of Catra's head.

'I'm sorry for neglecting you all day. Wanna watch that one show?'

'Sounds perfect.'

Chapter End Notes

Personally, I read this is as a sequel of chapter 23, but hey. You can also read this as your regular one shot!

Train gain

Chapter Notes

> WE REACHED 2.000 HITS!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!
> WHOOP WHOOP!!!!!!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Prompt: "I know what this looks like."

***

The train is a really good place to think about some stuff.

Adora certainly has thought about things. For example, how could the pretty girl in front of her be asleep?

The only reason that Adora sat down in a four seater was because it was the only option. Literally, the whole train was so full, she's never felt this much resemblances to sardines in a can.

Someway, somehow she managed to sit down in a seat, next to a man who sat on his phone, making sure that nobody saw what was on his screen. The other seat was taken by an old looking grandma, making a Swiss crossword out of a day-old newspaper.

They were gone, now. One of the most popular train stations made this train feel real empty real fast.

Now Adora was left alone, with a pretty girl sleeping in front of her.

Adora seriously didn't know how she could do that. She always felt on edge in public transport, and hell, most of the time at home too.

Well… home…

It wasn’t really much of a home yet, but moving out was a necessity if she didn’t want to be wrecked by traveling for her Master’s degree each day.

It started tomorrow and Adora was… excited?

Yeah, she was. Only her excitement was coated by a layer of nerves. Would she like it there? Make any friends? Be capable of living on her own?

You know what? That didn’t matter.

Right now, the biggest question on her mind was how the pretty girl could make falling asleep in one of those dingy train seats look so comfortable.

Maybe it was because of how her hair fell down to frame her face, or how her face was free of worry.

It could also be the fact that she was bundled up underneath her jacket, using it as a blanket.

God, she was truly beautiful.

Adora shouldn’t stare this much. Oh lord, she was being creepy.

What if the girl woke up and saw how Adora was straight up analysing her?

(Well, if Adora was being honest with herself, the reason why was everything but straight.)

She looked out of the window, trying to take her mind off of things by appreciating the scenery.

Only, it was October, meaning that even though it wasn’t so late, it was dark outside. There were lights flying by every so often, but she mostly saw the reflection of herself in the window. That, and the reflection of the girl.

Adora should distract her mind another way. Too bad that she forgot her earphones at home, or she'd be listening the new album of her favourite pop artist.

Although, that was all about yearning and love and stuff, so maybe it was the better choice not to listen to that.

Comedic timing or not, Adora was feeling thirsty.

She looked at one of the screens in the train that gave information about the next station.

Seven minutes, it read.

Enough time.

Adora opened her bag and took out her water bottle. She twisted the cap off, and right at the moment that her lips made contact with the bottle, the train jostled her around.

How could a train track be bumpy?

She looked down at her now-soaked pants, full of water. It wouldn't be too long until she got home, at least.

Adora heard chuckling in front of her. She raised her head and was eye to eye with the pretty girl. Figures that she also woke up. The girl looked even prettier awake, her eyes were dancing with mirth. It was the same way one would look at you, whenever their friend had talked shit about you, and remembered it.

Wait, but why was she glancing down at Adora's pants every so often?

Oh…

'I know what this looks like-' Adora started, '-but it's water.' To enunciate her point further, she pointed at with her free hand to her water bottle. The movement caused her to spill more on herself.

She twisted the cap back on. Sometimes, Adora wasn't great at doing things.

Especially when a girl hotter than the fucking sun so much as glances her way.

Catra laughed at the scenery before her and searched in her bag for something.

Adora's face was burning up in the meantime, hoping that it helped the water evaporate from her pants. If not, she hoped that *she* was the one evaporating.

'Here.' Catra said, offering a pack of tissues.

'Thank you.' The tissues helped a little. She went from soaked to slightly less soaked.

Adora held her hand stretched out again to give the package back.

She got a smile back, and the words 'You can keep them.'

With that, Catra was gone, out of the train, but certainly not out of Adora's mind.

***

Catra was walking into her class when she spotted the same dumb hair poof she saw yesterday on the train.

That hot ass clumsy goddess, Catra thought.

She sat behind a desk, drinking from a water bottle.

Oh, what a timing.

Adora's eyes meet Catra's and she almost chokes on the water. She's coughing and wheezing, punching her chest with her fist.

She’s still alive, thank goodness, but Adora’s spilt water over her pants again.

Renewed confidence fills Catra and she walks over. ‘I guess I’ll sit here today, to make sure you keep from spilling, princess.’ Catra throws another pack of tissues on Adora’s desk.

Adora needs to choke again, despite not drinking.

This is going to be a fun year.

Chapter End Notes

i can't believe that after tomorrow, it's done
just one more fic and it's over

We'll meet again

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Prompt: "I'm not alone and neither are you."

***

'I can't believe this is over.' Adora said, her hands gripping the chains of the swing more tightly. A breeze reminded her of the October cold. It was one of the reasons why the playground was deserted.

'Me neither.' Catra balanced the tips of her feet forward and backwards, making her move slowly on the swing.

Adora looked at her friend. She met her that first year of high school and now, six years later they were still side by side.

She looked down at her shoes, taking in the grey, rubber tiles. Grass found its way between the cracks, as a cryptic metaphor or something.

'I don't wanna go to uni.'

'Adora. You've worked your ass off to get there, for about six years.'

'Yeah, but-'

'You even chose a study for *you*.'

'That's true, but-'

'And you've talked about how cool it would be to go to archeologic sightings.'

‘It *would* be cool…’ Adora looked up at Catra. ‘It’s just less cool without you there.’ She moved her hand to interlace hers with Catra. Her face heated, remembering that her friendship with Catra was that. A *friendship*. ‘Or, or! The rest of the group, of course!’

Adora moved their hands that were hanging in the middle of them, gently swaying forwards and backwards. She really wanted to enjoy this moment and be in the here and now, but she couldn’t put some things out of her head.

Would she feel home there? Would she meet friends? No matter what, they sure as hell wouldn’t be as amazing as Catra.

Catra, who means the whole world to her and so much more.

‘I don’t want to lose you, ‘Cat. I don’t want to be…’ She stared intently at the ground.

‘Adora... I’m not alone and neither are you.’

‘Yada yada yada, my moms already told me about new friends, but that’s different!’

Catra caressed Adora’s hand with her thumb. Many people thought that Catra wasn’t a patient person, and they were right. She *did* have a special spot for Adora and her antics, though. ‘That’s not what I meant, dummy.’ She raised their hands up and gave a kiss on Adora’s hand. ‘Nothing really bad can happen, as long as we have each other.’

Did a raindrop just fall into Adora’s eye? Because it was getting watery up there, for no reason at all.

‘Nothing can stop us from being together, okay? Different cities, schools and *lives* won’t keep us from each other.’

Through her eyes she saw a blurry Catra. ‘You promise?’

‘Yes, I promise princess. Besides, we’ll only be an hour away.’

‘That’s too far.’ A tear escaped Adora’s eye. It couldn’t travel much, Catra caught it before it fell.

‘I know. But we can visit each other all the time. I’ll annoy the crap out of you, making you *wish* that you could get rid of me.’

The corners of Adora’s mouth raised.

‘There’s that smile!’

‘I don’t think I’ll ever get enough of you.’

‘And I can’t get enough of you too.’

***

(And they really meant it.

They tried *their bests* to get enough of each other. Constant phone calls, late night drives and shared vacations were nothing out of the ordinary. At one time, Catra even drove over to give Adora a hug.

It was a surprise to no one that they stayed together forever with such intertwined lives.)

Chapter End Notes

> And that, dear readers, is a wrap!
>
> First and foremost I’d like to give one BIG ASS SHOUT OUT to, Liseo, GemR and Dooeey66!!!!!!!!!!
>
> They commented a lot on this fic, while I was writing it and that kept me going this whole damn month! Without them, I’m sure I’d given up on day three, or something. It’s so nice to know that there are people out there that actually read and enjoy this!
>
> I can’t believe I’ve really finished fictober. I started picking up writing again last year in mid-October and since then I’ve

wanted to join this challenge.

I also can't believe that you're reading this right now?!?!?!? That means that you've also reached the end of this fic?!?!?!?! What????

I'm flabbergasted

I don't know what to say!

Thank you for giving this fic the time of day, it means a damn much to me!!!!!!!!!

Next month is nanowrimo btw, and im not going to join that! I don't think I've ever strained my thinking muscle this much, so I'll settle for a nap!

Also also, this whole month I've procrastinated saying that I have a Twitter account now. I don't really post often, but it's me! @notahumanweirdo

And now, some stats and thoughts about doing this project for future me, because I'm a giant nerd!
- I've spent 1180 mins in that document
- shortest fic is chapter 4, with 269 words (hehehe, nice)
- longest fic is chapter 20, with 2332 words
- average words per fic are 1000 words, hehehe
- I deadass uploaded chapter 19 without using the prompt sentence, because i forgot to write it
- I feel like I've undersold a lot of these fics because of the time crunch
- Sometimes the characters felt OOC while writing! I'm curious to see if that's still true after i reread this
- I also wonder how repetitive all of these fics were
- I'm really glad that I could write some scenes that were in my head for a long time, but weren't enough for a whole stand alone fic
- I was also happy to write some fics that have more world building than I usually do!

- I’m physically incapable of writing an unhappy catradora ending and you know what? That’s okay.
- I’ve posted every prompt on the right day of the prompt!!!! That’s really cool!!!!
- It is possible to write the gayest fanfics on the train
- My fic ideas are always fluff. I think my brain likes fluff-city
- This is my biggest! Fanfic! In terms of! Hits, comments and words!!!!!!
- Yeah, I’ll just say it even though it sounds stupid, but I’m proud of this thing. I really am. :D!
that’s it, that’s all

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!